

The Hyperion Schubert Edition

MARIE McLAUGHLIN
GRAHAM JOHNSON

Complete Songs
Sämtliche Lieder
Mélodies Intégrales

13



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lieder sacred and profane

With the help of Schubert's diary, let us examine the events of four consecutive days in the summer of 1816. On 13 June, he attended a party, played some of his songs, and heard Mozart's G minor String Quintet:

"A bright, light, beautiful day this will remain throughout my whole life . . . O Mozart, immortal Mozart . . . how many, oh how infinitely many such beneficial impressions of a brighter and better life you have stamped upon our souls . . . I also made the acquaintance of Mme Jenny, an extraordinarily fluent pianist, who however seems to be somewhat lacking in true and pure expression."

"14 June . . . I took an evening walk for once, as I had not done for several months. There can scarcely be anything more agreeable than take an evening stroll in the countryside after a hot summer's day . . . In the uncertain twilight and in company with my brother Karl, I felt so happy — 'How beautiful' I thought and exclaimed, standing still delightedly. A graveyard close by reminded us of our dear mother. Thus talking sadly and intimately ('unter traurig traulichen Gesprächen') we arrived at a point where the Döbling road divides."

"15 June . . . Among all the pictures a Madonna and Child by Abel appealed to me most . . ." [at an exhibition of Austrian painting in the Sankt Annagebäude in the Annagasse] "I realise that one has to look at such things often and intently to find and receive the right expression and impression."

"16 June . . . To look on pure, holy nature, must be the greatest pleasure for an artist who, guided by such a one as Gluck, learned to know nature and to uphold it in spite of the unnatural conditions of our age." [At a gathering in honour of his teacher Antonio Salieri]

Schubert's evening walk with his brother Karl lies at the heart of a busy and eventful week. We can imagine the sad and intimate conversation between them as they strolled in the fields between Währing and Döbling, and spoke of their mother who had died four years earlier. Nostalgic for the seemingly endless golden summers of childhood, most of us at nineteen believe that we are ageing fast, and that those days "of splendour in the grass, of glory in the flower" are forever lost; the pain of facing the adult world is assuaged by memories of . . .

*" . . . those first affections,
Those shadowy recollections,
Which be they what they may,
Are yet the fountain light of all our day,
Are yet a master light of all our seeing
Uphold us, cherish and have power to make
Our noisy years seem moments in the being
Of the eternal Silence: truths that wake,
To perish never."*

Schubert's diary of 1816 is full of the strivings of the young would-be philosopher to cope with the difficulties of growing up — intimations of immortality, albeit expressed in prose which is admittedly no match for the glories of Wordsworth's verse of nine years earlier. The day after the evening walk, perhaps on the recommendation of his brother who was to become an accomplished draughtsman and landscape artist, Schubert went to an exhibition of paintings held in the same building which housed Karl's art school. The picture that "appealed to him" was apparently executed in life-size figures, and entitled *The Virgin Mary showing her sleeping Child to the angels with motherly delight*. The

painter, hardly remembered today, was Josef Abel (1764-1818). Very recent researches suggest that Abel may have painted the composer's portrait around 1815. On 16 June Schubert heard the 'pure, holy nature' of Salieri's Muse. But the day before at the exhibition, he had seen pure, holy nature, albeit on canvas rather than in the flesh. It cannot be mere coincidence that he found himself touched by a Mother and Child the day after being reminded of his own mother. There is no extant portrait of her and, relying only on his memory, it might have been that she had become an icon of purity and goodness in the composer's mind, and that the picture of the Madonna took on the universal features of Everymum.

Throughout his life Schubert measured much in terms of clarity, purity, brightness, and because we happen to have his diary for the period, this is particularly well-documented in 1816. It seems that he was seeking out images of purity everywhere, as if he needed to take refuge from thoughts hounding him in other directions; he needed to find an aesthetic, and perhaps ascetic, counterbalance to his burgeoning sensuality. It is no surprise that the immortal Mozart is "brighter and better" than anyone else, but the remarks on Madame Jenny's pianism show that there were others who fell short of the ideal. Contrast this with a letter Schubert wrote to Schober in 1818: "dein Sinn für die Kunst ist der reinste, wahrste, den man sich denken kann" (your feeling for art is the *purest* [my italics] and truest imaginable). Schober was lauded for his "*reinsten* Sinn"; Madame Jenny lacked "*reiner* Ausdruck"; Salieri valued "*reine*, heilige Natur."

For many lovers of Lieder, that word 'rein' is indelibly linked with Ellen's address to the Virgin Mary: 'Ave Maria! Reine Magd! — Ave Maria! Pure Maiden!' And thus we return to the nativity painting, and the profusion of messages and feelings which seem to be tumbling out of Schubert's mind and into his diary: the love of an adolescent boy for his dead mother, his admiration for the pure genius of Mozart and for a great teacher unadulterated (so Schubert idealistically thought) by life's hurly burly, and on the other hand his disappointment that a pianist he has heard lacked the purest of expression. Her art, even perhaps the woman herself, did not measure up to an ideal of purity which he was then to see captured by the painter Abel's brush: Mary, the perfect, unsullied woman fixed in a frame for all time (or so Schubert might have thought — the picture is no longer extant).

As he contemplated the nativity scene, is it possible that the reassuring warmth and the sweet pangs of remembered mother's love were overtaken by a fascination with the Virgin's womanly attributes — the glow of her skin, the warmth of her smile, the outline of her figure? Is it not possible that Schubert made the most of this opportunity to stare long and hard at such a model of feminine beauty? Heinrich Heine was yet to write his celebrated poem *Im Rhein, im heiligen Strome* (set in Schumann's *Dichterliebe*) which concludes with the poet finding the Virgin Mary painted on golden leather in Cologne Cathedral headily (and bodily) reminiscent of his beloved. But Schubert might have had an experience even more disturbingly complicated than the poet's, whose own bossy mother was unlikely to have entered Heine's picture: having seen his mother in the Virgin, did Schubert then perceive a beautiful and desirable woman? This might have introduced Oedipus into a scenario already seething with psychological confusion, but in a country where hypocritical double standards abounded, where lip-service of different kinds could be both paid and paid for by those who both adhered to, and flouted, morality, this confusion and mingling of sacred and profane would have been nothing unusual. The almost blasphemous *frisson* provided by religious art is a phenomenon probably as old as painting itself. (Today, blasphemy is more overt, and teenage girls look to quite another Madonna as a role model.)

We know that Schubert was in love at the time with a neighbour's daughter, Therese Grob, then aged eighteen, and that he had been fond of her for two years. Their affair, if so it could be called, was coming to an end — it was almost certainly without a physical outlet, and doomed for practical reasons, mainly financial. One can imagine his initial joy in believing that he had found a soul mate in a girl with a pretty soprano voice, and his disappointment in finally realising that nothing would come of the relationship. Added to that there was also the age-old frustration of the adolescent doing dutiful battle with his physical urges: one part of him putting his girl on a pedestal, another part of him urging him to knock her off. One can imagine the turbulent feelings of a young man brought up in the bosom of the Catholic church (his father was very strictly religious, 'apt to moralise' as he himself once confessed in a rare flash of humour) coming to terms with repellent or delightful thoughts of impurity, depending from which ankle (tiny feet were a major nineteenth-century turn-on) you looked at them. Young Schubert had been brought up to accept unquestioningly the teachings of the church on morality, but the more rational side of him, prompted by the anti-religious feelings of an elder brother and new friends, fought against them. He was at one with nature when it came to enjoying the countryside in walks with his brother Karl, but uncertain of his own attractiveness and eligibility, and of his right to enjoy his sexual feelings, he was, in Woody Allen's words, "at two with nature" when it came to accepting his physical self. At least this seems to have been the case in the summer of 1816. The diary for 8 September contains a number of rather ponderous aphorisms, one of which is: 'To a free man matrimony is a terrifying thought in these days: he exchanges it [freedom] either for melancholy or crude sensuality.' It is obvious that Schubert has an ambivalent attitude both to marriage (did he really want to marry Fräulein Grob?) and to what he terms crude sensuality ('grobe [my italics] Sinnlichkeit'). He continues with "O God, shroud our feelings and senses in numbness" — a plea to be released from all sensuality. But did he really mean this, I wonder? It was these disruptive and Dionysian forces which gave vital life to his compositions, for at this time the music always dared to go further than the man himself. In 1825 the perspicacious Anton Ottenwalt remarked that Schubert's genius seemed unimpaired by "the passions of an eagerly burning sensuality". But this was in the future; in 1816 he confides his confusion to his diary, the conflict of his inherent idealism with the powerful propulsions of adolescence. As Stefan Zweig has written in his autobiography "We find in the literature of the nineteenth century only the merest trace of all the perils, shadows, and confusions of the young man in the big city." The city he means is Vienna of course, hardly different in this respect in Schubert's time to Zweig's. The extremely discreet diaries and letters of the Schubert circle give little hint of the many passions playing beneath the surface, not to mention the temptations faced by young men who, having escorted flirtatious virgins back to their mothers, made their way home past the brightly painted girls plying their trade, for which Vienna was notorious throughout Europe.

This disc mirrors some of the ambivalence of the age in matters social and sexual. In stark contrast to the religious atmosphere of the opening song, *Das Marienbild*, two of Seidl's *Refrain Lieder*, simultaneously coy and suggestive, illustrate not only the Viennese taste of the time in lighter music, but also the artificially imposed and rigorously enforced dichotomy between the world of the 'nice' girl and the 'bad', between the *Lied* and the *Liedchen*. A vivid description of 'one thing leading to another' in *Die Männer sind méchant* is followed by the inevitable tragedy when a 'nice' girl is persuaded, by the most seemingly sincere protestations of love, to surrender her virtue. It is this mixture of sacred and profane in one person, a pure girl with a heart sensual enough to be invaded by devilish tricks, which helps make Goethe's Gretchen the most famous fallen woman in German literature, and Schubert's

Gretchen am Spinnrade a trailblazer in the history of song. A second theme of the disc, related to the first, is Marie McLaughlin's native Scotland, which German speakers, enthused by the Ossian translations from as early as 1760, considered a land of the noble savage, faithful to age-old traditions and possessing a rare purity of sentiment. Gretchen is thus counterpointed at the other end of the recital by Ellen Douglas, a radiant paragon of Scottish womanhood for whom Schubert found some of his most beautiful music. Ossian's Shilric and Vinvela inhabit a world of pagan gods and goddesses, but Ellen's Highland clan is firmly Catholic. In their moments of greatest crisis both Gretchen and Ellen pray, in totally different ways, to the Virgin Mary. Identifying with the plights of his song characters, I doubt whether Schubert ever forgot the appeal and the reproach of Marian purity. Hers, rather than the contorted features of preachers threatening hell-fire, seems to have been for him the acceptable, perhaps even the desirable, face of religion.

At exactly the same time that the famous *Ave Maria* was composed, and performed with much success by Vogl and the composer on a tour of Upper Austria, Schubert wrote an impassioned letter to Ferdinand (21 September, 1825) which discussed, among other things, an infamous massacre of the Bavarians by the Tyrolese during the Napoleonic Wars in 1809. What Schubert objected to most was the way that a chapel and a cross were erected as memorials to the slaughter — "partly to commemorate and partly to expiate it by such sacred symbols . . . Thou glorious Christ, to how many shameful actions must thou lend Thy image!" These are scarcely the words of a conventionally religious man — even 'Thou glorious Christ' ('Du herrlicher Christus') has an ironic ring about it. And yet the composer was able to pour all his feeling, indeed his love, into songs to the Virgin, who is a sacred symbol if ever there was one. I believe that this is because the chastening, inspiring figure of Mary, womanhood, *das Ewig-Weibliche*, call her what one will, stood for Schubert as a corrective to the violence of a male-dominated world, including the violence of war which, for all his adolescent patriotism, and the song-exploration of its pageantry in the ancient or medieval worlds, had come to disturb him by 1825. He valued the attributes ascribed to Mary — mercy, tolerance, gentleness and forgiveness, qualities which we in turn value in his music. If indeed these attributes are feminine (some feminists of today see the Marian cult as a conspiracy to keep women humble in the Virgin's image) Schubert's occasional musical visits to Mary's shrine seem merely one of his ways of acknowledging the feminine in his own nature, a means of personifying the innate goodness of both man- and womankind. If he had been brought up by his parents to revere and respect Mary, this is perhaps one of the reasons why he has an extraordinary sympathy with, and empathy for, women in general. Gretchen's song seems no more written by a man than Juliet's protestations of love to Romeo; character and composer are at one. In a heart-breaking letter written in the wake of his illness, to the painter Kupelwieser in Rome, Schubert quotes Gretchen's lines, and admits that he had, in a way, become his most famous song character: "Imagine a man whose health will never be right again . . . imagine a man whose most brilliant hopes have perished, to whom the felicity of love and friendship have nothing to offer but pain — *My peace is gone, my heart is sore, I shall find it never, and nevermore* I may well sing every day now, for each night, on retiring to bed, I hope I may not wake again, and each morning recalls yesterday's grief." In his music of feminine heartbreak and despair Schubert displays a profound understanding of the female psyche. It is not enough for him to play the role of the male observer extending the hand of pity to the social outcast; he seems to understand from within.

It takes little imagination to deduce from this that Schubert regarded himself as something of an outcast too. It is true that he was unlike 'the others', the good-looking young men of his circle, the debonaire Schobers and Bruchmanns and Schwinds, as much in visible things like height and build, as in the indefinable musical forces working within him. His genius, and the vast responsibilities this gave him as its vessel, set him apart from an early age. But it also seems likely that the conflicts between duty and rebellion, love and lust, Apollo and Dionysus, Christian and pagan, indeed male and female, were extremely powerful and complicated, and in the earlier years cost him a lot of thought and not a little pain. In this he was exceptionally sensitive, but in large measure he was also simply a child of his time; not even Schubert was able easily to shake off the powerful guilt and remorse which his religious upbringing had inculcated into him as effectively as into millions of others. But fortunately for us he had a means of reconciling the two worlds: the powerful interplay of opposing forces produced much great music. It has often enough been said that Schubert's music has tears in its laughter and a smile shining through its tears, but it may equally be remarked that in his music the forces of the sacred and profane, the innocent and the erotic, are fused into an astonishingly mature and self-accepting entity. It seems likely that the four diary entries quoted from 1816 chronicled a period where Schubert was on the brink of taking to heart something he wrote in September 1816: "Take people as they are, not as they should be." If he had known Shakespeare he might have had the courage to quote Parolles in *All's Well That Ends Well*: "Simply the thing I am shall make me live." Perhaps one of the most succinct summings-up of the composer was by the man who was eventually to introduce the composer to some of Shakespeare's lyrics, Eduard von Bauernfeld. In a diary entry for 8 March 1826, Bauernfeld wrote: "Schubert has the right mixture of the idealist and the realist. The world seems fair to him." Many experiences, both happy and tragic, paved his way to that state of balance; he came to accept, and learned to work with, the sacred and profane in his own nature. And we are the lucky beneficiaries of that accommodation.

Aloys Schreiber (1761-1841)

DAS MARIENBILD

D623 August 1818; first published 1831 in Book 10 of the *Nachlass*

PICTURE OF THE VIRGIN MARY

Sei begrüßt, du Frau der Huld,
Und der reinen, schönen Minne,
Ohne Makel, ohne Schuld,
Und von demutsvollem Sinne!

Fromme Einfalt wölbte dir
Diese ärmliche Kapelle
In den Stamm der Eiche hier
Ohne Säulen, ohne Schwelle.

Vögelein auf jedem Ast
Singen deinem Kindlein Lieder.
Durchs Gezweig im goldnen Glast
Steigen Engel auf und nieder.

Und dem Herzen wird so leicht,
Wär es auch von Gram umspinnen,
Und dem Pilger wird gerecht
Labung aus dem Gnadenbrunnen.

Hail, gracious Lady
Of pure, fair love,
Without blemish, without guilt,
Humble in spirit.

In pious simplicity
This lowly chapel was raised to you
In the trunk of this oak,
With neither pillars nor threshold.

On every bough
Birds sing their songs to your child;
Angels, bathed in golden radiance,
Move up and down amid the branches.

And the heart, though oppressed with grief,
Is made light;
And the pilgrim finds refreshment
At the fount of grace.

Wohl ein Hüttlein baut ich gern
 Hier im stillen Waldegrunde,
 Daß mir dieser Meeresstern
 Leuchte nun um jede Stunde;
 Daß in diesem kleinen Raum
 Mir der Himmel angehöre,
 Daß kein banger, böser Traum
 Meinen letzten Schlummer störe.

I would fain build a little hut
 Here in the silent forest,
 That the star of the sea
 Might shine for me now and always;
 That in this small space
 Heaven might be mine,
 And that no troubled, evil dream
 Might disturb my last sleep.

This is one of four Schreiber settings from 1818, the first of which, *An den Mond in einer Herbstracht* (Volume 8) is one of the neglected masterpieces of the Schubert canon. It seems that the composer discovered a volume of Schreiber's poetry in the spring of that year (the poems had been published in 1817) and had taken it with him to Zseliz where he took up residence in July as music master to the children of Count Esterházy. *Das Marienbild* is one of two Schreiber songs written in Hungary that summer. John Reed has suggested that they were composed 'by request', as Schubert was 'not at this time in sympathy with orthodox piety.' It is possible that one of his new employers spotted the poem in the Schreiber volume and persuaded Schubert to set it. Another poem featuring Mary was composed in that summer (*Blondel zu Marien*, D626), but if these Zseliz settings were not a reflection of the composer's own enthusiasm, why should he return to the theme in Vienna with a compelling Stabat Mater in song, *Vom Mitleiden Maria* (D632, December 1818) long after the terms of his employment had ended? It seems more likely that Schubert continued to be as interested in Mary-in-music as he had always been. One has simply to look at a list of the works devoted to the Madonna in Schubert's church music: the first of these, a *Salve Regina*, D27, dates from 1812, then a *Salve Regina*, D106 (1814), a *Stabat Mater*, D175, and *Salve Regina*, D223, both from 1815, the *Deutsches Salve Regina*, D379, the *Stabat Mater*, D383, the *Salve Regina*, D386, the *Magnificat*, D486 (all four from 1816, the year Schubert admired Abel's picture), the *Salve Regina*, D676, of 1819 and a last *Salve Regina*, D811, in 1824.

Unlike the zealots of the Reformation, Schubert had no reason to blame the corruption and bigotry of the church on the worship of images; how could someone with his kind of imagination have been against imagery after all? It was the images which were beautiful and were misused by men to inspire fear rather than love. And Marian resonances went beyond Christian belief. Guided by classically educated friends, and perhaps having visited the museum of antiquities in the Hofburg, Schubert became interested in Greek and Roman mythology. The statues of gods and goddesses were also spiritual ideas turned into image. It might well have been pointed out to the composer that the ancient pagan worship of Venus or Ceres had played a large part in the growth of the Christian veneration (a word which in itself seems to derive from Venus) for the Virgin Mary.

In this song, the simplicity of the forest chapel, no more than an icon set in an oak tree, suggests a pagan shrine; on the other hand, the music for *Lied eines Schiffers an die Dioskuren* (Volume 14), a heartfelt pagan hymn, would not have been out of place in a church. In Schubert's music Christian and pagan, sacred and profane, are sometimes capable of interchange and reconciliation. The accompaniment is mostly in the rich tenor range of the piano and suggests horn music, the sound one may hear from the distant hunt in the middle of a forest. The tender chromaticisms of the vocal line, which suggest a votary's tentative awe, weave around the unblemished C major tonality, a key which often implies clarity and purity. (Schubert chose this key for the last of his settings of *Salve Regina*,

D811, an unaccompanied work for four men's voices which has much of the mellow mood and tessitura of the accompaniment of *Das Marienbild*.) The repetition of the last line of each verse leaves the supporting harmony more or less unchanged, but miraculously suggests a two-way exchange between supplicant and goddess, a prayer answered in fact, simply by altering the shape of the vocal line, and bringing it to the fulfilment of the cadence. There is also a courtly quality to this strophic song, which in its simplicity of form and ornamented florid vocal line suggests the art of the troubadour, and the Marian cult of the crusades — a favourite epoch of Schubert's Lieder imaginings. It is also a manifestation of the so-called Nazarene movement in literature and painting. Blondel, Richard the Lion Heart's minstrel, is the protagonist of Schubert's next song, *Blondel zu Marien*, D626 (September 1818) which is even more floridly melismatic. We might be tempted to place the shrine of *Das Marienbild* in Sherwood Forest, and to cast the aptly named Maid Marian as its singer, were it not the fact that the singer Johan Michael Vogl was only to introduce Schubert years later to Walter Scott's *Ivanhoe* where Robin Hood plays a part. The vocal lines of both *Das Marienbild* and *Blondel zu Marien* hint at Vogl's influence however, inclined as he was to 'improve' Schubert's vocal lines by ornamenting them in the eighteenth-century manner of his youth.

Johann Gabriel Seidl (1804-1875)

2 DIE UNTERSCHIEDUNG

866 No 1 Summer 1828(?); published in 1828 as Op 95

THE DISTINCTION

Die Mutter hat mich jüngst gescholten
Und vor der Liebe streng gewarnt.
"Noch jede," sprach sie, "hat's entgolten:
Verloren ist, wen sie umgarnt."
D'rum ist es besser, wie ich meine,
Wenn keins von uns davon mehr spricht:
Ich bin zwar immer noch die Deine —
Doch lieben, Hans! — kann ich dich nicht!
Bei jedem Feste, das wir haben
Soll's meine größte Wonne sein,
Flicht deine Hand des Frühlings Gaben
Zum Schmucke mir in's Mieder ein.
Beginnt der Tanz, dann ist, wie billig,
Ein Tanz mit Gretchen deine Pflicht;
Selbst eifersüchtig werden will ich
Doch lieben, Hans! kann ich dich nicht.
Und sinkt der Abend kühl hernieder
Und ruh'n wir dann recht mild bewegt,
Halt' immer mir die Hand an's Mieder,
Und fühle, wie mein Herzchen schlägt!
Und willst du mich durch Küsse lehren,
Was stumm dein Auge zu mir spricht,
Selbst das will ich dir nicht verwehren
Doch lieben, Hans! kann ich dich nicht.

Mother recently scolded me,
And warned me sternly against love.
"Every woman," she said, "has paid its price;
She who is ensnared by love is lost."
And so I think it better
If neither of us speaks of it again.
I am in truth still yours for ever,
But love you, Hans — this I cannot do!

Whenever we have a holiday,
It will be my greatest joy
If your hands twine the gifts of springtime
To adorn my bodice.
When the dancing begins, then — as is only fair —
It will be your duty to dance with Gretchen;
I shall even be jealous.
But love you, Hans — this I cannot do!

And when cool evening descends
And we rest, filled with tender emotion,
Keep your hand on my bodice,
And feel how my heart beats!
And if you wish to teach me with kisses
What your eyes silently tell me,
Even that I shall not deny you.
But love you, Hans — this I cannot do!

A change of mood from utter purity to teasing ribaldry. 'The Distinction' of the title is the difference between love and love, nudge nudge, wink wink, you know, the real thing. Reed avers that this song

resembles Lieschen's aria in *Die Zwillingbrüder* (1820), as indeed it does in terms of its key and certain other characteristics; the difference is that Lieschen's is a tender song of sexual awakening, a plea for independence from her father (and such it is meant to be taken seriously) whereas this song feigns propriety merely to inflame passion. One is reminded of Victorian music hall songs where the punters were delighted by the interplay of mock innocence and concealed experience. That Schubert was prepared to publish songs of this type was simply a career move, the equivalent of the efforts of great classical singers of today to beat the pop world at its own game. Significantly, he entered into this field only after it had been established beyond all doubt that he was a serious composer of challenging and innovative music; a younger man might have run the risk of being typecast as lightweight, something of which Schubert, bless him, could never have been accused in any respect. Broad comedy was never his strongest suit, and he was simply not sufficiently interested in setting poetry which played to the masses. This having been said, the two songs on this disc (in a more popular vein than the other two *Refrain Lieder*) are highly effective when the right singer has a glint in the eye. The poet Seidl, seven years Schubert's junior, to whom the songs are dedicated, was something of a go-getter. Only in his early twenties, but already well known, the newly appointed editor of the almanac *Aurora* and ambitious for success in all spheres, he might have played a part in persuading the composer to write and publish the songs. It is significant however that Schubert wrote him a letter in August 1828 (not in the English edition of the documents) addressed ironically to 'Herr Gabriel' and returning poems which he found unsuitable for setting. So much for the theory that Schubert would set anything by his friends.

The music is earthy and illustrative and the vocal line has a teasing bounce and flounce to it. The piano part is a clever depiction of the scolding mother, her jabbing remonstrative finger playing repeated notes in the strident heights of the treble. In the gesturing of this piano music, with crushed notes for emphasis, there is a prophetic hint of the crabby lecturing of Hugo Wolf's *Rat einer Alten*. For the fifth line of each verse the song moves to the key of B flat, which suggests an abrupt change of subject and a quick readjustment of dress. Indeed, Hans is never far away, his marauding hands are written into the very bodice of the song. The girl's first 'doch lieben Hans, lieben kann ich dich nicht' seems to lure the boy towards her in a fine example of Biedemeier doublespeak given piquant musical life by Schubert's interrupted cadence, but the repeat of the words pushes him away, not before having toyed with the word 'Liebe' as a promise of things to come. As in Wolf's *Auf dem grünen Balkon*, the eyes (and the voice) say 'Yes', the fingers (and the accompaniment) say 'No.' It was ever thus in courtship; but here we somehow know that she would be able to love him if the price were right.

Johann Gabriel Seidl (1804-1875)

3 DIE MÄNNER SIND MECHAN?

D866 No 3 Summer 1828(?); published in 1828 as No 3 of *Vier Refrain Lieder*, Op 95

MEN ARE NAUGHTY!

Du sagtest mir es, Mutter:
Er ist ein Springinsfeld!
Ich würd' es dir nicht glauben,
Bis ich mich krank gequält!
Ja, ja, nun ist er's wirklich;
Ich hatt' ihn nur verkannt!
Du sagtest mir's, o Mutter:
"Die Männer sind mechan!"

You told me, mother:
He's a young rogue!
I would not believe you
Until I had tormented myself sick.
Yes, I now know he really is;
I had simply misjudged him.
You told me, mother:
"Men are naughty!"

Vor'm Dorf im Busch, als gestern
 Die stille Dämm'rung sank,
 Darauscht' es: "GutenAbend!"
 Da rauscht ' es: "Schönen Dank!"
 Ich schlich hinzu, ich horchte;
 Ich stand wie festgebannt:
 Er war's mit einer Andern —
 "Die Männer sind mechant!"

O Mutter, welche Qualen!
 Es muß heraus, es muß! —
 Es blieb nicht bloß bei'm Rauschen,
 Es blieb nicht bloß bei'm Gruß!
 Vom Gruße kam's zum Kusse,
 Vom Kuß zum Druck der Hand
 Vom Druck, ach liebe Mutter! —
 "Die Männer sind mechant!"

Yesterday, as dusk fell silently,
 In the copse outside the village,
 I heard a whispered "Good evening!"
 And then a whispered "Many thanks!"
 I crept up and listened;
 I stood as if transfixed:
 It was he, with someone else —
 "Men are naughty!"

O mother, what torture!
 I must be out with it, I must!
 It didn't just stop at whispering,
 It didn't just stop at greetings!
 It went from greetings to kisses,
 From kisses to holding hands,
 From holding hands . . . ah, dear mother,
 "Men are naughty!"

Seidl understood what would appeal to the public at the same time as being sufficiently ambiguous to pass the censor. This poor girl has been duped and betrayed by naughty men; what can men now do to comfort her? The presence of a mother adds a prurient edge to the subtext — "if she is still relying on her mother's advice and guidance, how young can she really be?" There could be no greater contrast to the maternal role of the Virgin Mary. Nothing is what it seems, even the title actually means something exactly opposite to what it says — men are bastards, but they're really "absolutely lovely". There is no greater composer than Schubert for the expression of real innocence, but the girl's hurt at her betrayal and her wide-eyed shock at the facts of life sound phoney to me, although I have sometimes heard singers attempt to bring a sincere sense of desolation to the story. The tempo, a slowly swinging two beats in a bar, has to vary with the verses, and has to be slow enough for the words to register; at certain moments the story is spun out to titillate the voyeur, but at others the pulses race. The middle of the song (lines five and six of each verse, before the refrain) consists of three sequences of mounting intensity, shifting from A minor to A major (a surprisingly ecstatic affirmation of the tonic major considering that the girl is supposedly upset and that men are being berated), and enhanced by a furtive exploration of the mediant. The snatched beats' rest between these stages of activity (particularly effective in the third verse) suggest the panting of the pantless. The crossing of hands, unusual in Schubert's accompaniments, and a famous nineteenth-century means of enabling male and female piano duettists to improve their acquaintance, seems in itself suggestive of hanky panky. The final two chords, marked suddenly piano after a forte postlude, have the effect of a knowing wink at the audience.

Johann Wolfgang von Goethe (1749-1832)

GRETCHEN AM SPINNRADE

D118 19 October 1814; published as Op 2 in 1821

Meine Ruh' ist hin
 Mein Herz ist schwer,
 Ich finde sie nimmer
 Und nimmerehr.

GRETCHEN AT THE SPINNING-WHEEL

My peace is gone,
 My heart is heavy,
 I shall never, never again
 Find peace.

Wo ich ihn nicht hab'
Ist mir das Grab,
Die ganze Welt
Ist mir vergällt.

Mein armer Kopf
Ist mir verrückt
Mein armer Sinn
Ist mir zerstückt.

Nach ihm nur schau' ich
Zum Fenster hinaus,
Nach ihm nur geh' ich
Aus dem Haus.

Sein hoher Gang,
Sein' edle Gestalt,
Seines Mundes Lächeln,
Seiner Augen Gewalt.

Und seiner Rede
Zauberfluß,
Sein Händedruck,
Und ach, sein Kuß!

Mein Busen drängt sich
Nach ihm hin.
Ach dürft' ich fassen
Und halten ihn.

Und küssen ihn
So wie ich wollt'
An seinen Küssen
Vergehen sollt'!

Wherever he is not with me
Is my grave,
The whole world
Is turned to gall.

My poor head
Is crazed,
My poor mind
Is shattered.

I look out of the window
Only to seek him,
I leave the house
Only to seek him.

His fine gait,
His noble form,
The smile of his lips,
The power of his eyes.

And the magic flow
Of his words,
The pressure of his hand
And, ah, his kiss!

My bosom yearns
For him.
Ah, if only I could grasp him
And hold him.

And kiss him
As I would like,
I should die
From his kisses!

The name Gretchen has already made an appearance on this disc in *Die Unterscheidung*; she is the girl with whom the boy will dance to make his lover jealous — she is little Margaret alias Peggy, Maggie, the archetypal girl, anyone and everyone. Mahler in his *Hans und Grethe* writes of the round-dance of life and sex — boy meets girl, Jack has his Jill. In Goethe's *Faust*, Gretchen is the typically good German girl, with rough hands from hard work, who is seduced, made pregnant and abandoned. She kills her child and is sentenced to death. Just as the unjust execution of a young unmarried mother stirred Dickens's reforming zeal, it is certain that the story of Gretchen was suggested to Goethe by certain famous cases of infanticide from his youth. During his student days in Leipzig, one Catherina Maria Flindt was sentenced to death for killing her illegitimate child; she was rescued from prison by her lover, but, tormented by her conscience, returned to face her execution. In Frankfurt in 1772, soon after Goethe had parted from his lover Friederike Brion, and at a time that he was feeling very guilty about his treatment of her, another infanticide, a girl by the name of Susanna Margareta Brandt, was publicly executed. Goethe's own doctor attended her, and the poet also knew the executioner.

The powerful story of Gretchen's seduction is told in Part One of *Faust* in a succession of scenes which the poet shuffled and expanded over the years. Sketches of the early and original *Ur-Faust* (1774-5)

suggest that the anguish of *Gretchen am Spinnrade* follows her deflowering; she realises that she is pregnant and foresees the horrors of her future. The version Schubert would have read makes it easier to assume that Gretchen sings the song in a state of arousal, her innocence threatened but not yet lost. Either interpretation of the character is encompassed by the lyricism and the searing intensity of Schubert's setting.

A study of the early songs confirms that many and various touches of genius existed in Schubert's Lieder well before 19 October 1814. But these earlier works, often overtly influenced by other composers, pale beside the *coup de maître* which is *Gretchen am Spinnrade*. To emerge from what had been a most distinguished apprenticeship into the realm of mastery, Schubert needed to find the right poet to set him on creative fire. It was Shakespeare who had liberated the young Goethe from the narrow precepts of his predecessors, and it was Goethe who performed the same service for Schubert. *Gretchen* is his first Goethe setting and it was love at first sight. There had been dalliances with the idealised Elisa, Adelaide and Laura of Matthisson (Volume 12) but these were 'nice' girls; in *Gretchen*, who is on the brink of being engulfed by her own turbulent emotions and the strictures of a cruel world, the composer recognised the new frank reality of the romantic age, his own reality perhaps, and the full implications of his song-writing destiny. This most auspicious of days in the Lieder calendar was preceded, on 18 October 1814, by one of the biggest open-air celebrations ever known in Vienna, a thanksgiving and *Volksfest* in the Prater, to mark the first celebration of Napoleon's defeat at the Battle of Leipzig, and the freeing of the German nations from the French yoke. Offerings of gratitude were made on specially constructed altars to celebrate German-Austrian cooperation. A feeling that he was living in great and stirring times perhaps helped encourage Schubert, the next day, to compose the first of many immortal collaborations between Weimar and Vienna, German word and Austrian tone.

As the stage directions demand, Schubert places the scene in Gretchen's room; we are made to hear the claustrophobia of an enclosed space in the constriction and repetitiveness of a vocal line which is hemmed in until it breaks wildly out of its cage. The accompaniment represents the spinning-wheel, with the tick-clack of the bobbin in the left hand, counterpointing the rotation of the wheel, but it is a spinning-wheel capable of mirroring orchestral sonority, a big dipper following the ups-and-downs of the human heart. The piano's notes, trapped within a small space on the stave, transcend the original intent of their imagery: they seem like Gretchen's confused thoughts hammering in her brain, their relentless movement, driven by an inescapable obsession, fuelled by blind panic and momentarily stalled by desire, suggest something more diabolical than a wooden wheel and a spinner's foot-pedal. And from the musical and structural point of view it is the movement of this spinning dynamo which pulls together all the strands in the song and weaves them into imperishable yarn.

Goethe has set out his verse in short lines, simplicity and desperation all in one, and Schubert has found a musical means to mirror that structure: each line is followed by a rest, a short gap between statements. The piece starts in low gear veering between stretches of D minor, drained of expression and a shift to an unexpected C major which gives an archaic modal twist to the harmony. As soon as accidentals begin to pepper the page, Gretchen who has started the song in a depressed daze, warms into vehement life — the tessitura of 'die ganze Welt ist mir vergällt' in the chest register seems wrenched from the gut, while the heartstrings are set a-jangling by the sudden shift to an octave higher in 'mein armer Kopf ist mir verrückt'. Schubert does not shy away from the wail of hysteria inherent in this line; the voice is challenged to sit around E, F and G — the soprano's perilous *passaggio* — to

marvellous effect. Schubert now inserts a reprise of the opening verse; the poem does not need this repeat to establish a sense of obsession, but the music does, and each time we hear the refrain it seems subtly different. The thought of how handsome and good Faust is, applies the balm of the relative major (F). This section (Verses 5 and 6) is a miniature *Frauenliebe und -leben*; it starts as idealistically and demurely as that cycle, and as in *Er, der herrlichste von allen*, progresses to a description of the beloved's best points. Schumann's heroine is eventually happily married, but the stories of the two women dramatically diverge as fleeting key shifts trace Gretchen's whirlwind courtship. The slippery slope of the chromatic scale for 'Zauberfluss' is a marvellous touch, suggesting, as it somehow does, a flood of artfully insincere words. And then the clasp of his hand, and then his kiss — a searing memory thrown into the void created by Faust's cruel absence. And then silence.

Governed by mechanical habit, for the wheel is her work and drudgery, Gretchen sets it turning once more. Where to go from here? Another repeat of the refrain, and a lesser composer would have been in a spin as to what to do next. The simple change from D minor to B flat major for 'Mein Busen drängt sich' is positively wanton in its effect; it is as if Gretchen has lifted and proffered her breasts. Goethe meant something at least as strong as this — his original lines here were 'my womb longs for him.' For thirty seconds we hear a force of nature unleashed, Amazonian womanhood denuded of all propriety; she wants to kiss Faust as *she* would like, sister of the women who would tear Orpheus limb from limb. It is this that was unheard of in song, altogether more revolutionary than the invention of a wheel. Is this desire, hysteria, anger, fear or a mixture of them all? With almost each bar the harmony changes, rising and panting, the senses spinning and whirling. The storm culminates in two top A's, and suddenly all passion is spent and we hear once more the quiet desperation of 'Meine Ruh' ist hin'. The only flaw in this masterpiece is one of vocal practicality: most singers would be grateful for just one more bar of spinning interlude to come down from the 'high' of hysterical passion and make the transition to the bereft return of the refrain. Johann Vogl asked for a similar mercy in a passage in *Erkönig* and Schubert made the necessary alteration.

Johann Wolfgang von Goethe (1749-1832)

5 SZENE AUS FAUST

(second version)

D126 December 1814; first published in 1832 in Book 20 of the *Nachlass*

SCENE FROM FAUST

Böser Geist
Wie anders, Gretchen, war dir's,
Als du noch voll Unschuld
Hier zum Altar tra'tst,
Aus dem vergriffenen Büchelchen
Gebete lalltest,
Halb Kinderspiele,
Halb Gott im Herzen!
Gretchen! Wo stehst dein Kopf?
In deinem Herzen, welche Missethat?
Bist du für deiner Mutter Seele,
die durch dich zur langen,
langen Pein hinüberschlief?
Auf deiner Schwelle wessen Blut?

Evil Spirit
How differently you felt, Gretchen,
When, still full of innocence,
You came to the altar here,
Murmuring prayers
From your shabby little book,
Half playing children's games,
Half with God in your heart.
Gretchen! How is your head?
What sin lies within your heart?
Do you pray for the soul of your mother,
Who because of you
overslept into a long, long agony?
And whose blood lies on your threshold?

— Und unter deinem Herzen
Regt sich's nicht quillend schon,
Und ängstigt dich und sich
Mit ahnungsvoller Gegenwart?

Gretchen

Weh! Weh!
Wär' ich der Gedanken los,
Die mir herüber und hinüber gehen
Wider mich!

Chor

Dies irae, dies illa,
Solvat saeculum in favilla.

Böser Geist

Grimm faßt dich!
Die Posaune tönt!
Die Gräber beben!
Und dein Herz, aus Aschenruh
Zu Flammenqualen wieder aufgeschaffen,
Bebt auf!

Gretchen

Wär' ich hier weg!
Mir ist als ob die Orgel mir
Den Athem versetzte,
Gesang mein Herz
Im Tiefsten lös'te.

Chor

Judex ergo cum sedebit,
Quidquid latet adparebit,
Nil inultum remanebit.

Gretchen

Mir wird so eng!
Die Mauern-Pfeiler befangen mich!
Das Gewölbe drängt mich! — Luft!

Böser Geist

Verbig dich! Sünd' und Schande
Bleibt nicht verborgen.
Luft? Licht? Wehe dir!

Chor

Quid sum miser tunc dicturus?
Quem patronum rogaturus?
Cum vix justus sit securus.

Böser Geist

Ihr Antlitz wenden
Verklärte von dir ab.
Die Hände dir zu reichen,

And beneath your heart
Does not something already stir and swell,
Tormenting itself and you
With its foreboding presence?

Gretchen

Alas! Alas!
If only I could be free of the thoughts
Which run to and fro in my mind,
Against my will.

Chorus

Dies irae, dies illa,
Solvat saeculum in favilla.

Evil Spirit

Anguish grips you!
The trumpet sounds,
The graves tremble!
And your heart, stirred up again
From ashen peace to blazing torment,
Trembles likewise!

Gretchen

If only I could escape from here!
I feel as if the organ
Were taking my breath away,
And the singing dissolving my heart
In its depths.

Chorus

Judex ergo cum sedebit,
Quidquid latet adparebit,
Nil inultum remanebit.

Gretchen

I am so afraid!
The pillars of the walls are constricting me!
The vault presses down on me! — Air!

Evil Spirit

Hide yourself! Shame and sin
Will not remain hidden.
Air? Light? Woe upon you!

Chorus

Quid sum miser tunc dicturus?
Quem patronum rogaturus?
Cum vix justus sit securus.

Evil Spirit

The blessed turn their faces
From you.
The pure shudder

Schauert's den Reinen.

Weh!

Chor

Quid sum miser tunc dicturus?

Quem patronem rogaturus?

To reach out their hands to you.

Woe!

Chorus

Quid sum miser tunc dicturus?

Quem patronem rogaturus?

Johann Faust was a real itinerant magician who lived in the first half of the sixteenth century. He acquired a reputation for magical powers, and by 1587 what purported to be his story was published in Frankfurt in the *Faustbuch*. This was translated into English as *The historie of the damnable life, and deserved death of Doctor John Faustus*, and formed the basis of *Dr Faustus* (published 1604-16) by Christopher Marlowe. The Faust story was then apparently re-exported to Germany via Marlowe's play and a company of English actors, and it survived there in puppet theatre. The story of Faust has thus long been understood as drama, but it was the range of Goethe's interests and achievements as a writer, and his tendency to endlessly tinker with the text, which make his work very difficult to stage; it is easier to read *Faust*, the poet's life work, as a compendium of philosophy and verse styles, noble and popular. Fortunately, a Lieder composer can make light of the logistics of theatrical staging and six weeks after composing *Gretchen am Spinnrade*, Schubert seized on this scene.

The first thing that strikes the listener of today is that Schubert gives this scene an operatic treatment supposedly not yet invented. It mirrors the words in a flow of recitative which can only be compared to that of Wagner in its harmonic audacity and expressive power; it is as if Mephistopheles himself has emboldened the composer to look into the future. The opening consists of a pair of ascending three-note phrases which sidle up to the heroine with malicious intent. In this scene, Gretchen never answers the 'Böser Geist' or acknowledges his presence. In the stage directions this Evil Spirit is behind her, but whether the devil (is it he, or one of his plenipotentiaries?) is invisible to Gretchen is unclear. Does she hear his voice whispering in her ear, or do his taunts masquerade as the workings of her own conscience? He speaks in seductive tones of honeyed sympathy, like a torturer persuading his victim to relax, all the better to surprise her with sudden pain. The words 'altar' and 'God' (and later 'heart' and 'soul') all occasion the rise of a fourth, as if to put them in the inverted commas of sneering irony. The sinister two bars of chromatically rising harmonies before 'Gretchen! wo stehst dein Kopf' insidiously suggest psychic rape. Gretchen is taunted with her pregnancy, and in accusing her of planning to kill the child as yet unborn, the spirit plants in her the seed of the idea. The baby stirs within her, and Schubert invents a figure, a slow writhing trill in tenths to depict the stirring of the threatened foetus. In all three of her frenzied interruptions of this stream of manipulative abuse, Gretchen sings in the most uncomfortable part of her voice — a shrill contrast to the baritone's ease. 'Weh! Weh! war ich' (D flat, D natural, E flat) are accompanied by three ascending diminished sevenths leading to a chord of E flat; the fingers of the right hand make every effort to break out of the straitjacket — they try shifting notes in the middle of the chord, changing the position of thumb and little finger, until they break out into the temporary respite of G major. This introduces the C minor chorus of 'Dies irae', sung only too aptly, by members of the congregation. Condemned on all sides, Gretchen is caught between the Devil and the Holy See. The implacable strength of the chorale rhythm contrasts with the wayward indiscipline of Gretchen's thoughts. The Evil Spirit now throws off all pretence at gentleness. The horrors of judgement at the resurrection, last trump and all, are gloatingly described, and lead to further self-laceration on the highly-strung chromatic wire. The chorus again, and for the third time Schubert finds constricted music of fear and claustrophobia for his poor heroine. ('Mir wird so eng!'). In calling

for air, the voice claws its way out of a mass of chromatic debris. This is the last we hear of her, for it is here (rather than later, as in the play) that she faints. In the last line of the scene in Goethe, Gretchen calls for smelling salts, something which Schubert wisely avoided setting to music. It is only in the last choral refrain (for the first time marked *piano*) that Schubert allows a touch of compassion for his stricken heroine. And here he leaves her until May 1817. This is the last time we encounter Gretchen in the play, until we find her in chains in prison, and condemned to death.

Johann Wolfgang von Goethe (1749-1832)

[6]

GRETCHENS BITTE

D564 May 1817; published as a fragment in 1838. Completed in this version by Benjamin Britten (1913-1976). The verses set by Britten are printed in italics

GRETCHENS PRAYER

Ach neige
Du Schmerzenreiche,
Dein Antlitz gnädig meiner Not!
Das Schwert im Herzen,
Mit tausend Schmerzen
Blickst auf zu deines Sohnes Tod.
Zum Vater blickst du,
Und Seufzer schickst du
Hinauf um sein' und deine Not.
Wer fühlet,
Wie wühlet
Der Schmerz mir im Gebein?
Was mein armes Herz hier banget,
Was es zittert, was verlangt,
Weißt nur du, nur du allein!
Wohin ich immer gehe
Wie weh, wie weh, wie wehe
Wird mir im Busen hier!
Ich bin, ach, kaum alleine,
Ich wein', ich wein', ich weine,
Das Herz zerbricht in mir.
*Die Scherben vor meinem Fenster
Bethaut' ich mit Thränen, ach!
Als ich am frühen Morgen
Dir diese Blumen brach
Schien hell in meine Kammer
Die Sonne früh herauf,
Saß ich in allem Jammer
In meinem Bett schon auf.
Hilf! Rette mich von Schmach und Tod!*
Ach neige,
Du Schmerzenreiche,
Dein Antlitz gnädig meiner Noth!

You who are laden with sorrow,
Incline your face graciously
To my distress.
With the sword in your heart,
And a thousand sorrows,
You look up at your dying son.
You gaze up to the Father,
And let a sigh rise up
For His affliction and your own.
Who can feel
How the pain
Gnaws away in my bones?
What my poor heart fears,
What it dreads, what it craves,
Only you can know!
Wherever I go,
How it hurts, how it hurts
Here in my breast!
Alas, no sooner am I alone
Than I weep, I weep,
And my heart breaks within me.
*Ah, I sprinkled with dewy tears
The broken pots at my window!
When early this morning
I plucked these flowers for you.
When the early sun shone brightly
Up into my room
I, in all my misery,
Was already sitting up in bed.
Help! Save me from shame and death!*
You who are laden with sorrow,
Incline your face graciously
To my distress!

In the story-line of Goethe's *Faust*, this scene (which is listed as *Gretchen im Zwinger* in the Deutsch catalogue) comes between two texts already heard on this disc. As the last of Schubert's *Faust* compositions it closes the group of Gretchen songs in this recital.

In the previous scene in the play, Gretchen has conversed with her friend Lieschen at the town well. She hears the gossip about the shameful fate of one Bärbelchen, and the ignominy brought about by her pregnancy. Her lover has abandoned her, and now she will have to do public repentance for her sin. Gretchen realises that this is also the tragic truth of her own story. Desperate and ashamed she visits the shrine of the Virgin, a statue of Mary placed in a niche 'im Zwinger' — in the city ramparts. Goethe gives over the whole of the scene to a single lyric of operatic scope and intensity, justly famous and complete in itself. Nearly eighteen months after the other Gretchen songs, it is obvious that arioso and recitative now interest Schubert far less than the challenge of writing a through-composed aria. This may account for the fact that the piano, for all the richness of the accompaniment's texture, is reduced to a supporting role. Almost all psychological interest in the song is concentrated in the vocal line, and this may have been one of the reasons why the composer abandoned the work after setting only five of the eight verses.

The opening flow of semiquavers in B flat minor, a tonality Schubert employed only a handful of times, is reminiscent of *Auf der Donau* D553 (Volume 2) written the month before, a song not dissimilar in its general dark mood. But that poem travels and sees sights on its way up the Danube; Gretchen's plight on the other hand is static. There is no spinning-wheel here to keep the song on the move; apart from her grief, she describes picking flowers and sitting on her bed, hardly material for interesting piano commentary. Even Ellen in *Ave Maria* has a harp to string her song along. And so in the absence of a background or implied stage business which is at the heart of many a lively Lied, it is simply Gretchen's grief which Schubert has to work with. The first nine lines of the poem seem a litany, a formal prayer which Gretchen knows by heart, however more poignant and significant the words seem to composer and audience, knowing her plight. And then suddenly her own thoughts take over. At 'Wer fühlet, Wie wühlet' the liturgical metre is abandoned, and major key yields to minor in a remarkable passage for the bottom half of the voice — a viola solo in a string quartet, burrowing painfully deep into the bone, the worm in the bud of the sick rose. The first three lines of Verse 5 use a trick familiar from the last pages of *Gretchen am Spinnrade*: a sequence of modulations, each one turning the screw of tension tighter. The last three lines of the verse, after some tearful repetition of words, dissolve, like all Gretchen's courage, into a broken-hearted C major. The composer then placed four flats on a new stave and abandoned the composition.

Benjamin Britten's completion of the work dates from 1943 and skilfully re-cycles Schubertian material. The music for Verse 6 is transposed from the A major of Verse 2 to the A flat tonality suggested by Schubert's final key signature. Verse 7 artfully recalls the rising major-key arpeggio of 'und störe, störe nimmer' from *Auflösung*, D807 (Volume 11) a song with which Britten and Pears were very well acquainted as performers. But the manner in which the twentieth-century composer meets the challenge of 'Hilf! rette mich von Schmach und Tod' — surely the heart, and point, of Goethe's poem — is more original, and convincingly Schubertian. Britten has the courage to repeat 'Hilf!' three times in the same hysterical part of the voice that Gretchen uses when she sings 'Weh! Weh!' in the *Szene aus "Faust"* D126, and he underpins this passage with similar shifting progressions, exploring various possibilities of enharmonic modulation. These lead the piano to a

climactic B flat minor chord in second inversion, over which the voice plummets from one end of its range to the other. Equally daringly, Britten invents a transition and inserts the words 'Ach, rette mich' twice — rhetorical additions to Goethe's poem, phrases that are supported by echoes of the opening semiquavers of the accompaniment. These prepare a touching recapitulation of the opening prayer, unaltered Schubert as is right and proper. The last of these lines is repeated with different harmonies leading to a newly invented and convincing final cadence for the piano.

In the next scene in the play, Gretchen's brother Valentin is killed in a duel with Faust and Mephistopheles. In his dying moments he calls her a whore. After this the 'Böser Geist' confronts her in church (D126). At the end of the play when Faust, in a fit of remorse, attempts to rescue Gretchen from the condemned cell, her soul is redeemed from on high. Her prayers are answered at last.



GRETCHEN
a late 19th-century engraving

James Macpherson ('Ossian') (1736-1796)

7 SHILIRIC UND VINVELA

SHILIRIC AND VINVELA

D293 20 September 1815; first published in 1830 in Book 4 of the *Nachlass*

Vinvela

Mein Geliebter ist ein Sohn des Hügels; er verfolgt die fliehenden Hirsche; die Doggen schnauben um ihn; die Senn seines Bogens schwirrt in dem Wind. Ruhst du bei der Quelle des Felsen oder beim Rauschen des Bergstroms? Der Schilf neigt sich im Wind, der Nebel fliegt über die Heide; ich will ihm ungesehn nahn; ich will ihn betrachten vom Felsen herab. Ich sah dich zuerst lieblich bei der veralteten Eiche von Branno; schlank kehrtest du vom Jagen zurück, unter allen deinen Freunden der schönste.

My love is a son of the hill. He pursues the fleeing deer. His dogs are panting around him; his bow-string sounds in the wind. Dost thou rest by the fountain of the rock, or by the noise of the mountain stream? The rushes are nodding to the wind, the mist flies over the heath. I will approach my love unseen; I will behold him from the rock. Lovely I saw thee first by the aged oak of Branno; thou wert returning tall from the chase; the fairest among thy friends.

Shilric

Was ist's für eine Stimme, die ich höre? Sie gleicht dem Hauche des Sommers! Ich sitz nicht beim neigenden Schilfe; ich hör nicht die Quelle des Felsen. Ferne, ferne o Vinvela, geh ich zu den Kriegen von Fingal: meine Doggen begleiten mich nicht; ich trete nicht mehr auf den Hügel. Ich seh dich nicht mehr von der Höhe, zierlich schreitend am Strome der Fläche; schimmernd, wie der Bogen des Himmels; wie der Mond auf der westlichen Welle.

What voice is that I hear? that voice like the summer wind! I sit not by the nodding rushes; I hear not the sound of the rock. Afar Vinvela, afar, I go to the war of Fingal. My dogs attend me no more. No more I tread the hill. No more from on high I see thee, fair moving by the stream of the plain; bright as the bow of heaven; as the moon on the western wave.

Vinvela

So bist du gegangen, o Shilric! Ich bin allein auf dem Hügel! man sieht die Hirsche am Rande des Gipfels, sie grasen furchtlos hinweg; sie fürchten die Winde nicht mehr; nicht mehr den brausenden Baum. Der Jäger ist weit in der Ferne; er ist im Felde der Gräber. Ihr Fremden! ihr Söhne der Wellen! o schonst meines liebeichen Shilric!

Then thou art gone, O Shilric! I am alone on the hill! The deer are seen on the brow; void of fear they graze along. No more they dread the wind, no more the rustling tree. The hunter is far removed; he is in the field of graves. Strangers! Sons of the waves! Spare my lovely Shilric!

Shilric

Wenn ich im Felde muß fallen, heb hoch, o Vinvela, mein Grab. Graue Steine und ein Hügel von Erde; sollen mich, bei der Nachwelt bezeichnen. Wenn der Jäger beim Haufen wird sitzen, wenn er zu Mittag seine Speise geneußt, wird er sagen: "Ein Krieger ruht hier;" und mein Ruhm soll leben in seinem Lob. Erinn're dich meiner, o Vinvela, wenn ich auf Erden erlieg!

If fall I must in the field, raise high my grave, Vinvela. Grey stones and heaped-up earth shall mark me to future times. When the hunter shall sit by the mound, and produce his food at noon, "Some warrior rests here," he will say; and my fame shall live in his praise. Remember me, Vinvela, when low on earth I lie!

Vinvela

Ja! ich werd' mich deiner erinnern; ach! mein Shilric wird fallen! Mein Geliebter! Was soll ich tun, wenn du auf ewig vergingest? Ich werd' diese Hügel am Mittag durchstreichen: die schweigende Heide durchziehn. Dort werd' ich den Platz deiner Ruh, wenn du von der Jagd zurückkehrtest beschaun. Ach! mein Shilric wird fallen;

aber ich werd' meines Shilriks gedenken.

Yes! I will remember thee, alas! my Shilric will fall! What shall I do, my love! when thou art for ever gone? Through these hills I will go at noon: I will go through the silent heath. There I will see the place of thy rest, returning from the chase. Alas! my Shilric will fall; but I will remember Shilric.

With this song we leave medieval Germany to journey to primeval Scotland and the poetry of Ossian, influential in Europe since the first German translations (from the English of James Macpherson) of this supposedly Gaelic verse were published in 1764. So powerful was this influence that Goethe asked his readers to believe that the hero's suicide in his *Die Leiden des jungen Werthers* was precipitated, in part, by a shared reading of Ossian. The enthusiasm for the role of the ancient bard, fashionable in the *Bardendichtung* poetry of the 1770s (and still apparent in many of the poems Schubert set by his contemporaries nearly fifty years later) was enhanced by the appearance of these epic poems. The minstrel was seen as a world-wide figure going back to the beginning of time; he was a priest-like idealist whose disinterested love of art and truth reminded men that they had lost touch with the higher spiritual (though not specifically Christian) values of yore.

There is a note in Volume 6 (for the ballad *Die Nacht*) detailing the background to the Ossian controversy and Macpherson's spurious 'translations'. The truth of the hoax was only firmly established at the end of the nineteenth century. What was it in these works that appealed to so many writers, musicians and painters, and to Schubert in particular? His first Ossian setting (*Kolmas Klage*, Volume 15) dates from 1815, as does his first foray into the Greek myths (*Körner's Amphiaras* Volume 14). It seems to me that wind-swept, misty Scotland was a northern counterpart to Schubert's Greece; if Greece was the cradle of intellectual civilization, Ossian's warriors and their women signposted a romantic age full of feeling, the more authentic for being untutored and instinctive. The last books Schubert ever read were by Fenimore Cooper whose Red Indians embody the attraction of the 'noble savage'. If ancient Greece meant clarity, light, hedonism, pagan energy in the major key, Fingal's Scotland was in the minor, mysterious and shrouded by the mists of time, cold rather than hot, more closely related to the sagas of the north in which all German speakers feel the background of their race. The warriors of Greece were capable of great heroism, but Ossian's heroes were even more like we ourselves would like to be — idealistically upright, trusty and true, with all the good and none of the bad of primitive peoples. The Rev Archibald Clark, gullibly defending Macpherson's integrity as late as 1870, writes of Ossian's female characters: "in purity, dignity and tenderness (they are) immeasurably superior to the coarse, scolding, fighting goddesses of Homer". Coarse in the gorse? Never! Schubert believed in the historical authenticity of this non-Christian race; in his mind they represented the power of the sacred and the ideal, a romanticised contrast to the searing reality of a Gretchen in *extremis*.

1 (Vinvla) The introduction bears a disconcerting similarity to 'God Save the King', probably co-incidental, unless Schubert had heard the tune hammered out at the first performance of Beethoven's 'Battle' Symphony in December 1813, or perhaps all around Vienna in celebration of the Allied victory at Waterloo a few months before he wrote this ballad. Shilric and Vinvla were, after all, British citizens in the broadest sense. All the musical illustrations, in the manner of Haydn's *Die Schöpfung*, precede what they describe: the flight of the deer (two of them, male and female in canonic imitation), the panting dogs (the modulation between two bouts of panting suggests great doggy willingness to please) and the fluttering sound of reverberating bow strings. The aria beginning 'Ruhst du bei der Quelle des Felsen' a duet between the vocal line and a cello in the pianist's left hand,

is a ravishing example of Schubert's water and nature music. When Vinvela goes to look for Shilric and decides to 'behold him from the rock' (the fast interlude before 'Ich sah dich zuerst liebeich') the climbing modulations echo the astonishing music to the same purpose in Haydn's *Arianna a Naxos*. This is followed by a short recitative which ends with a melting setting of 'der Schönste'; Schubert is stricken by Shilric's beauty through Vinvela's eyes.

2 (Shilric) We are not certain, as is often the way with this poetry, if we are dealing with Shilric in person, or whether it is his spirit who speaks in the manner of Mahler's *Wo die schönen Trompeten blasen*, a genre of *Knaben Wunderhorn* poem much influenced by Ossian. Schubert finds a wonderful little figure — a crotchet followed by a dotted minim in rising sequences — which is a perfect tonal analogue for the pricking up of Shilric's ears before the lines 'Was ist's für eine Stimme?' The same type of eloquent flowing plaint accompanied by double thirds ('Ich sitz' nicht beim neigenden Schiffe') has already been heard in the mourning music for the warrior killed at the end of the *Kenner Ballade*, D134 (Volume 12). The dogs pant dutifully as they are mentioned. The cupola of heavenly skies and the moon on the waters inspire a magical ten bars of infinite tenderness and rapture.

3 (Vinvela) This is set-piece aria in G minor which lacks some of the spontaneity of the recitatives. It has an old-fashioned eighteenth-century air, as if Schubert is attempting to depict the stoicism of former times. 'Felde der Gräber' plunges the voice to an all-time low with the worms. But this is followed by 'Ihr Fremden, ihr Söhne der Wellen' which is somehow much more personal — a twice-repeated phrase of Mozartian beauty and poise.

4 (Shilric) Steadfast music this, in F minor — a song of duty (Mit Würde) having to master love with a heavy heart but a patriotic will. The sixths between voice and accompaniment of 'Graue Steine' are stonily uncompromising. The casual everyday quality of the recitative 'wenn der Jäger beim Haufen wird sitzen' is lifted into realms of immortal fame and memory by a shift from F minor into a hushed G flat. Shilric's last arioso to his beloved, 'erinnre dich meiner, o Vinvela' achieves a genuinely lofty tone, and returns this section to F minor.

5 (Vinvela) Without any ado, Vinvela starts her final aria in A major. This gives a sudden lift to the proceedings that some have found inappropriate for a war widow ("Not altogether sorry to be rid of him" opines John Reed). This music begins with the same heady defiance of death, and its supposed ability to kill love, that we find in *Hektors Abschied* (D312, Volume 14) written less than a month later. But it conveys a more subtle mixture of emotions than most battle paeans. 'Ich werde diese Hügel am Mittag durchstreichen' suggest Vinvela as a prototype of Norna the roving soothsayer, a character we will meet later on this disc. The end of the piece does not end in a blaze of glory; we are left, rather, with Vinvela's private grief. The postlude in simple minims consigns Shilric softly to immortality in her breast; it is the Celtic counterpart to the heavenly means by which Ganymed is lifted to immortality on a cloud of rising minims in the final bars of his song (Volume 5). The mythologies of Ossian and that of the ancient Greeks are related to each other in Schubert's mind.

from *Percy's Reliques*, translated by J G Herder (1744-1803)

EINE ALTSCHOTTISCHE BALLADE

(first version)

D923 September 1827; first published in 1863

"Dein Schwert, wie ist's von Blut so rot?
Eduard, Eduard!
Dein Schwert, wie ist's von Blut so rot
Und gehst so traurig da! — O!"
"Ich hab geschlagen meinen Geier tot,
Mutter, Mutter!
Ich hab geschlagen meinen Geier tot
Und das, das geht mir nah! — O!"
"Deines Geiers Blut ist nicht so rot!
Eduard, Eduard!
Deines Geiers Blut ist nicht so rot,
Mein Sohn, bekenn mir frei! — O!"
"Ich hab geschlagen meinen Retroß tot!
Mutter, Mutter!
Ich hab geschlagen meinen Retroß tot!
Und's war so stolz und treu! O!"
"Dein Roß war alt und hast's nicht not!
Eduard, Eduard
Dein Roß war alt und hast's nicht not,
Dich drückt ein and'rer Schmerz! O!"
"Ich hab geschlagen meinen Vater tot,
Mutter, Mutter!
Ich hab geschlagen meinen Vater tot,
Und das, das quält mein Herz! O!"
"Und was wirst du nun an dir tun?
Eduard, Eduard!
Und was wirst du nun an dir tun?
Mein Sohn, bekenn mir mehr! O!"
"Auf Erden soll mein Fuß nicht ruhn!
Mutter, Mutter,
Auf Erden soll mein Fuß nicht ruhn!
Will wandern über's Meer! O!"
"Und was soll werden dein Hof und Hall,
Eduard, Eduard,
Und was soll werden dein Hof und Hall?
So herrlich sonst und schön! O!"
"Ach! immersteh's und sink' und fall,
Mutter, Mutter,
Ach immer steh's und sink' und fall,
Mag nie es wieder sehn! O!"

AN OLD SCOTTISH BALLAD

"Why does your brand so drop wi' blood,
Edward, Edward?
Why does your brand so drop wi' blood,
And why so sad gang ye, O?"
"O, I have killed my hawk so good,
Mother, mother,
O, I have killed my hawk so good,
And I had no more but he, O."
"Your hawk's blood was never so red,
Edward, Edward:
Your hawk's blood was never so red,
My dear son I tell thee, O."
"O, I have killed my red-roan steed,
Mother, mother!
O, I have killed my red-roan steed,
That erst was so fair and free, O."
"Your steed was old, and ye have got more,
Edward, Edward:
Your steed was old, and ye have got more,
Some other dole ye dree, O!"
"O, I have killed my father dear,
Mother, mother;
O I have killed my father dear,
Alas, and woe is me, O!"
"And what penance will ye dree for that,
Edward, Edward?
And what penance will ye dree for that?
My dear son, now tell me, O."
"I'll set my feet in yonder boat,
Mother, mother:
I'll set my feet in yonder boat,
And I'll fare over the sea, O."
"And what will ye do with your towers and your hall,
Edward, Edward?
And what will ye do with your towers and your hall,
That were so fair to see, O?"
"I'll let them stand tili they down fall,
Mother, mother:
I'll let them stand tili they down fall,
For here never more may I be, O."

"Und was soll werden dein Weib und Kind,
Eduard, Eduard?

Und was soll werden dein Weib und Kind,
Wenn du gehst über's Meer — O!"

"Die Welt ist groß! laß sie betteln drinn,
Mutter, Mutter!

Die Welt ist groß! laß sie betteln drinn,
Ich seh sie nimmer mehr! — O!"

"Und was soll deine Mutter tun?
Eduard, Eduard!

Und was soll deine Mutter tun?
Mein Sohn, das sage mir! O!"

"Der Fluch der Hölle soll auf Euch ruhn,
Mutter, Mutter!

Der Fluch der Hölle soll auf Euch ruhn,
Denn ihr, ihr rietet's mir! O."

Thomas Percy (1729-1811), Bishop of Dromore, was an important collector of ancient literature from many cultures; he translated works into English from Icelandic, Portuguese, Hebrew and Spanish. He is best remembered, however, for the *Reliques of Ancient English Poetry*, a three-volume collection published in 1765 and containing poems from mainly British sources from the earliest times to the reign of Charles I. This ballad which appears in the *Reliques* in archaic form ("Quhy dois zour brand sae drop wi' bluid, Edward?") found its way into Johann Gottfried Herder's *Stimmen der Völker in Liedern* — an anthology of songs translated from the old literature of many lands, and published in various forms between 1778 and 1807.

This was an epoch when German philosophers led the way in understanding of, and tolerance for, the diversity of the different races of the world. Herder was one of the first to foster the idea of a culturally based non-aggressive nationalism. He had written a major essay on 'Ossian and the Songs of Ancient Peoples' as early as 1773, and as both philosopher and translator he helped bring Scottish culture to the attentions of the German-speaking world. Felix Mendelssohn, the grandson of another great philosopher, underwent considerable physical discomfort, as did numerous other travellers, in his journey through Scotland. It seemed richly worthwhile, salutary even, for those who had read their Ossian and thrilled to Schiller's *Maria Stuart*. The country was romanticism incarnate, and visitors agreed that the backward Scots had a strength and integrity which pointed to spiritual virtues long forgotten by nations with easier histories. The stage was set for the international triumphs of Walter Scott, himself a scholar of German literature and much influenced by Thomas Percy's anthology. Scott's *The Lady of the Lake* explores what he called "the ancient manners, the habits and customs of the aboriginal race by whom the Highlands of Scotland were inhabited."

This poem is known best in Loewe's celebrated setting which dates from 1818, nine years before Schubert's song. The Brahms duet, Op 75 No 1, was written fifty years afterwards. Schubert's song is much more simple than either, and it is probably because of this that it has been all but dismissed by the commentators. At first glance it seems to have little in common with the great songs of the composer's last years, but the hypnotic repetition of, say, the four verses of *Des Fischers Liebesglück*, D933 (Volume 6) reminds us that the composer was showing a new interest in the challenges of the

"And what will ye leave to your bairns and your wife,
Edward, Edward?

And what will ye leave to your bairns and your wife,
When ye gang o'er the sea, O?"

"The world's room, let them beg thro' life,
Mother, mother:

The world's room, let them beg thro' life,
For them never more will I see, O."

"And what will ye leave to your own mother dear,
Edward, Edward?

And what will ye leave to your own mother dear?
My dear son, now tell me, O."

"The curse of hell from me shall she bear,
Mother, mother!

The curse of hell from me shall she bear,
Such counsels she gave to me, O."

strophic song at this time. Many of the songs of *Winterreise* from the same year are also strophic and achieve the distilled simplicity which is the main characteristic of *Eine altschottische Ballade*. The setting is among the most phlegmatic the composer ever wrote from the point of view of notes (or lack of them); Schubert's response to murder most foul with a twist of implied incest is to lay the bones bare, and to allow the interpreters to do the rest. He resists the dramatic approach of Loewe and allows the murderer, and the instigator of that murder, to speak with the banality of true evil. As a young man he had been attracted to *Sturm und Drang*, but as a mature artist he refuses to do the obvious; there is no blood and thunder in the music, only a hollow type of shock and revulsion. If one accepts this, one can come to think of the underplaying of this setting as a masterly game of cat-and-mouse between the protagonists, and with the listener; it is certainly a song which seems ineffective on paper, but which somehow generates a sinister excitement in performance.

Loewe's *Edward* was published in 1824, and it is not impossible that Schubert was shown this setting, and perhaps challenged to equal it, by the pianist Marie Pachler with whom he was staying in Graz in September 1827. By coincidence, Josef Abel whose nativity scene had so appealed to Schubert at the art exhibition in 1816, had painted a portrait of Marie Pachler in 1817. On page 469 of Deutsch's iconographical volume we can see this picture — a Biedermeier muse with harp in rather a seductive pose. The link is rendered more curious by the fact that Frau Pachler was the mother of a little boy, Faust (for whom Schubert wrote a charming piano duet, *Kindermarsch*), and that the Scottish ballad set in Graz, at Marie's behest (so Faust's memoirs tell us), shows Edward and his mother caught up in a web of twisted evil. In the context of this programme, this song is a grisly antithesis to the idealised Christian relationship of mother and child.

Andrew MacDonald (1757-1790) quoted by Sir Walter Scott (1771-1832); translation by Sophie May (?)

[9]

LIED DER ANNE LYLE

ANNOT LYLE'S SONG

D830 early 1825 (?) ; published in 1828 as Op 85

Original lines from *Love and Loyalty* by Andrew Macdonald, quoted by Sir Walter Scott in *The Legend of Montrose* (translator unknown). A literal translation of Sophie May's German version is given here.

Macdonald's original is printed below in italics.

Wärs't du bei mir im Lebenstal,
Gern wollt' ich alles mit dir teilen;
Mit dir zu flieh'n war' leichte Wahl,
Bei mildem Wind, bei Sturmes Heulen.
Doch trennt uns harte Schicksalsmacht
Uns ist nicht gleiches Loos geschrieben
Mein Glück ist, wenn dir Freude lacht
Ich wein' und bete für den Lieben.
Es wird mein töricht' Herz vergeh'n
Wenn's alle Hoffnung sieht verschwinden
Doch soll's nie seinen Gram gesteh'n,
Nie mürrisch klagend ihn verkünden.
Und drückt des Lebens Last das Herz,
Soll nie den matten Blick sie trüben,
So lange mein geheimer Schmerz
Ein Kummer wäre für den Lieben.

If you were with me in life's valley,
I would gladly share everything with you;
It would be an easy choice to fly with you
In gentle breezes, or in the howling storm.
But the harsh power of fate separates us;
We are not granted the same destiny.
Happiness is mine when joy smiles upon you;
I weep and pray for my beloved.
My foolish heart will beat no more
If it sees all hope vanish.
But it shall never admit its grief,
Nor proclaim it with sullen lament.
And if life's burden oppresses my heart,
It shall never cloud my weary eyes
While my secret sorrow
May distress my beloved.

Wert thou, like me, in life's low vale,
 With thee how blest, that lot I share;
 With thee I'd fly wherever gale
 Could waft, or bounding galley bear.
 But parted by severe decree,
 Far different must our fortunes prove;
 May thine be joy — enough for me
 To weep and pray for him I love.

The pangs this foolish heart must feel,
 When hope shall be forever flown,
 No sullen murmur shall reveal,
 No selfish murmurs ever own.
 Nor will I through life's weary years,
 Like a pale drooping mourner move,
 While I can think my secret tears
 May wound the heart of him I love.

In Walter Scott's *A Legend of Montrose*, Annot Lyle was carried off in infancy (and in complicated Scott-plot fashion) by a savage tribe known as the Children of the Mist; later she was snatched away once again, this time during a raid by the M'Aulay clan, and raised as one of their own. At the time of the novel she is eighteen but 'she might have passed for four years younger.' Of almost saint-like disposition, she is a veritable Mignon of the North, given to singing with angelic voice and playing on the *clairshach*, the Scottish harp. She is torn between her true affections and her loyalty to the choleric Allan M'Aulay. The poem, 'a little Gaelic song' comes from an opera text entitled *Love and Loyalty* by one Andrew M'Donald (as Scott spells it in the archaic Scottish manner) who went to London to make his fortune in the theatre, and died young in miserable circumstances in Kentish Town. Scott quotes it just after M'Aulay has revealed his love to Annot, and threatened her if she continues secretly to love the Earl Menteith, for whom, in any case, she considers herself unworthy by birth. Annot eventually discovers that she is the daughter of the noble Duncan Campbell of Ardenvoehr; she is able to marry Menteith, of course, and thus effects a reconciliation (always a paramount theme in Scott's work), in this case between the factions of Cavalier and Presbyterian.

If we wish to find a musical clue to the character of her song we have only to follow her progress through the book, which suggests that Schubert did the same: 'her affection was of that quiet, timid, meditative character' who shies away from 'presumptuous or daring hopes.' The music somehow manages to sound as unaffectedly simple as a Scottish folk song. Einstein explains this by drawing parallels with the Andante of the E flat Piano Trio, D929, in the same key and with a similar kind of C minor melody with throbbing staccato accompaniment which also switches suddenly to E flat major. It is said that that movement is modelled on a Swedish folk song, and a certain 'Nordic' character is common to both pieces. The harmonies and repetitions suggest the soft turning away of wrath, direct confrontation side-stepped by a small, well-turned ankle, for here is also the momentum of a slow, sad dance, perhaps a reflection of Scott's description of her in Chapter V as 'the most beautiful little fairy certainly that ever danced upon a heath by moonlight'. In a similar way, Mignon's *Heiss mich nicht reden*, D877 No 2, has the air of a transcendental pavane. With the arrival of C major there are brave smiles through tears. The shyly insistent repeated thirds of the opening of the piano's ritornello tug at the sleeve and the heartstrings; together, voice and piano dare to dream of love, all the while miraculously mirroring Scott's description of a lack of presumption, legato cantilena alternating with staccato passages, where Annot steps forward in a boldness born of strong emotion, only to retreat in diffidence. Although it lacks the rounded immediacy and variety of Gretchen's music, this song is an unjustly forgotten gem in the Schubert catalogue.

GESANG DER NORNA

D831 Early 1825 (?); published in 1828 as Op 85

A literal rendering of Spiker's translation is given here. Scott's original poem is printed below in italics.

Mich führt mein Weg wohl meilenlang
Durch Gold und Strom und Wassergrab.
Die Welle kennt den Runensang
Und glättet sich zum Spiegel ab.

Die Welle kennt den Runensang,
Der Golf wird glatt, der Strom wird still;
Doch Menschenherz, im wilden Drang,
Es weiß nicht, was es selber will.

Nur eine Stund' ist mir vergönnt,
In Jahresfrist, zum Klagetun,
Sie schlägt, wenn diese Lampe brennt —
Ihr Schein verliert sich — sie ist entflohn.

Heil, Magnus Töchter, fort und fort!
Die Lampe brennt in tiefer Ruh';
Euch gön'n' ich dieser Stunde Wort,
Erwacht, erhebt Euch, hört mir zu!

*For leagues along the watery way
Through gulf and stream my course has been;
The hillous know my Runic lay,
And smooth their crests to silent green.*

*The hallow know my Runic lay —
The gulf grows smooth, the stream is still;
The human hearts, more wild than they,
Know but the rule of wayward will.*

My course leads me for many a mile
Through gulf and stream and moat;
The waves know the Runic lay
And grow mirror-smooth.

The waves know the Runic lay,
The gulf grows smooth, the stream is still;
But the heart of man, in its wild impulse,
Does not know its own desires.

I am granted only one hour in the year
To sing of my woes;
It strikes when this lamp burns —
When its gleam dies the hour has fled!

Hail, daughters of Magnus, forever hail!
The lamp burns in deep peace;
To you, at this hour, I tell my tale.
Awake, arise, hear me!

*One hour is mine, in all the year,
To tell my woes — and one alone;
When gleams this magic lamp, 'tis here —
When dies the mystic light, 'tis gone.*

*Daughters of northern Magnus, hail!
The lamp is lit, the flame is clear —
To you I come to tell my tale,
Awake, arise, my tale to hear!*

The Pirate dates from 1821. Set in Zetland (Shetland) and the Orkneys, it is one of Scott's most successful and imaginative novels. No less a critic than William Hazlitt waxed lyrical about its qualities. When Scott is gone, he exclaims, 'Ah! who will call the mist from the hill? Who will make the circling eddies roar? . . . Who will summon the spirits of the northern air from their chill abodes, or make gleaming lake or hidden cavern teem with wizard or with elfin forms? There is no one but the Scottish Prospero, but old Sir Walter, can do the trick aright.'

The story is set around 1700. The hero is Clement Cleveland, a buccaneer who is shipwrecked on the Shetland coast. He is rescued and brought ashore, but his exotic presence wreaks havoc on the tightly knit community to which chance has brought him. Ulla Troil, or Norna of the Fitful-head as she is known because of the towering sea-cliff where she dwells as a recluse, believes she possesses supernatural powers. Her bogus spells and prophecies enable her to meddle in the lives of the superstitious islanders with fateful results for herself and her son, whom she eventually discovers to be Cleveland himself.

The song occurs in Chapter XIX of the novel. Brenda and Minna, daughters of Magnus Troil, are both

having nightmares in which they hear 'some wild runic rhyme, resembling those sung by the heathen priests of old, when the victim (too often human) was bound to the fatal altar of Odin or of Thor.' They awake to find Norma sitting in their room and singing 'in a slow, sad, and almost unearthly accent.' She has come in the middle of the night to recount a complex narrative of woes. Today these portentous comings and goings would be the stuff (and nonsense) of high comedy; even the Victorians dispatched their pirates to Never Never Land or Penzance. Schubert endows Norma with more than a hint of hocus pocus, but he allows her to take herself as seriously as she is taken by her gullible captive audience. The song is set in the mezzo or contralto range, taking its cue from Brenda's dreams of 'deep tones and wild and melancholy notes.' As befits an incantation, it is strophic except for the vocal line at 'ihr Schein verlischt', the 6/8 rhythm swaying from side to side, which chimes with Scott's description of Norma 'who moved her body slowly to and fro over the pale lamp, as she sung.' The bottom-heavy accompaniment opaquely hugs the vocal line and suggests darkness and the smoke of the flickering lamp by which Norma sings. In gait and mood *Normas Gesang* is reminiscent of the last two verses of Matthiessen's *Romanze*. D114, which describe how the ghost of Rosalia de Montanvert haunts 'the ruins of the tower by the sea — the type of scenario developed by Scott from his readings of early German romantic writers, transplanted to a Scottish milieu, and triumphantly re-exported to German lands.

Sir Walter Scott (1771-1832), translated by Adam Storck

NORMANS GESANG

NORMAN'S SONG

D846 April 1825; published in 1826 as Op 52 No 5

A literal rendering of Storck's translation is given here. Scott's original poem is printed below in italics.

Die Nacht bricht bald herein, dann leg' ich mich zur Ruh,
Die Heide ist mein Lager, das Farnkraut deckt mich zu,
Mich lullt der Wache Tritt wohl in den Schlaf hinein.
Ach, muss so weit von dir, Maria, Holde, sein.

*Soon night will fall. Then I shall lie down to rest;
The heath shall be my bed, the bracken shall cover me.
The sentry's tread shall lull me to sleep.
Alas, I must be so far from you, Mary.*

Und wird es morgen Abend, und kommt die trübe Zeit,
Dann ist vielleicht mein Lager der blutige rote Plaid,
Mein Abendlied verstummet, du schleichst dann trüb und bang,
Maria, mich wecken kann nicht dein Totensang.

*Come tomorrow evening, come the bleak hour,
My bed may be the blood-red plaid;
My vesper song will cease, and you, Mary,
Will creep about, gloomy and troubled; your threnody will not waken me.*

So musst ich von dir scheiden, du holde, süsse Braut,
Wie magst du nach mir rufen, wie magst du weinen laut,
Ach, denken darf ich nicht an deinen herben Schmerz,
Ach, denken darf ich nicht an dein getreues Herz.

*Thus I had to leave you, fair, sweet bride.
Though you may call out for me, though you may weep aloud,
I cannot, alas, think of your bitter suffering,
I cannot, alas, think of your faithful heart.*

Nein, zärtlich treues Sehnen darf hegen Norman nicht,
Wenn in den Feind Clan Alpin wie Sturm und Hagel bricht,
Wie ein gespannter Bogen sein mutig Herz dann sei,
Sein Fuss, Maria, wie der Pfeil so rasch und frei.

*No, Norman cannot feel tender, devoted longing,
When Clan-Alpine bursts like hail and tempest on the foe;
His bold heart must be then like a drawn bow,
His foot, Mary, as swift and free as an arrow.*

Wohl wird die Stunde kommen, wo nicht die Sonne scheint,
Du wankst zu deinem Norman, dein holdes Auge weint,
Doch fall ich in der Schlacht, hüllt Todesschauer mich,
O glaub, mein letzter Seufzer, Maria, ist für dich.

*A time will come when the sun does not shine,
You will totter towards your Norman, your fair eyes will weep;
But if I fall in battle, if grim death shrouds me,
Believe this, Mary: my last sigh shall be for you.*

Doch kehrt' ich siegreich wieder aus kühner Männerschlacht,
Dann grüssen wir so freudig das Nah'n der stillen Nacht,
Das Lager ist bereitet, uns winkt die süsse Ruh
Der Hänfling singt Brautlieder, Maria, hold uns zu.

*But if I return victorious from the brave battle,
How joyfully we shall greet the approach of the silent night.
The bed is prepared, sweet repose beckons to us;
Soon, Mary, the linnet will sing us wedding songs.*

original

*The heath this night must be my bed,
The bracken curtain for my head,
My lullaby the warder's tread,
Far, far from love and thee, Mary.*

*To-morrow eve, more stilly laid,
My couch may be my bloody plaid,
My vesper song, thy wail, sweet maid!
It will not waken me, Mary!*

*I may not, dare not, fancy now
The grief that clouds thy lovely brow;
I dare not think upon thy vow,
And all it promised me, Mary.*

*No fond regret must Norman know;
When bursts Clan-Alpine on the foe,
His heart must be like bended bow,
His foot like arrow free, Mary.*

*A time will come with feeling fraught,
For, if I fall in battle faught,
Thy hapless lover's dying thought
Shall be a thought on thee, Mary.*

*And if returned from conquered foes,
How blithely will the evening close,
How sweet the linnet sing repose,
To my young bride and me, Mary!*

The tale of knightly Norman, 'heir of Armandave', is one of the various fragmentary stories which embroider the main narrative of Walter Scott's *The Lady of the Lake*. The author no doubt included it to press home the point that loyalty to clan and chief were paramount in sixteenth-century Highland

life. Like Annot Lyle, Norman faces the conflict between love and duty, a variant of the incompatibility of sex and religion. The overall theme of this epic poem, despite the central love story of Ellen Douglas and Malcolm Graeme, is the conflict between crown and clan at a time when Scotland was rent by internecine strife. The reconciliation brought about by the wisdom of a merciful king is Scott's broad historical lesson. Norman owes his allegiance to Roderick Dhu, chief of the Clan-Alpine, and sworn enemy of James V of Scotland. No sooner has he come out of the church with his bride Maria, than Angus the heir of Duncraggen appears with a fiery cross (having swum a turbulent stream to reach the chapel — all excellently recounted) to summon Norman to arms.

The text gave Schubert the chance to compose one of the two famous horse-riding songs of 1825 (the other is Schulze's *Auf der Bruck*) and one of the most effective of a favourite genre which included *Wilkommen und Abschied* (Volume 6) and *Erlkönig* (Volume 8). Like those songs, *Normans' Gesang* is a *moto perpetuo*, full of grim resolve. It is more authentically equestrian than the other accompaniments; we feel the rider bounce in the saddle as the horse gallops over uneven ground. The composer made it the finale of a group of Scott songs which he performed with Vogl in Linz in late July 1825. Anton Ottenwalt wrote to Josef von Spaun about this informal concert in a letter of 27 July; his remarks on *Normans' Gesang* are worth quoting in full:

"The warrior with his sacrificial torch, the summons to arms, sings as he fares across the country. Hurrying without respite he thinks of his errand, of the bride he has left at the altar, of the morrow's combat, of victory, of reunion . . . Schubert himself regards this as the best of the Scott songs. Vogl himself interprets it heavily (a syllable, often a word, to each note) but splendidly."

Modern listeners would perhaps place Ellen's songs on a higher plane than Norman's horse-ride but Schubert must have been proud of the symphonic scheme — artfully modified repetition, and the avoidance of monotony by changes of key at just the right moments — which holds a long song together; the Scott settings are all characterised by an inspired use of *ostinati* which unify long stretches of rhapsodic melodic invention. *Normans' Gesang* is sung here in the tenor original of C minor; the first verse stays in this key, but the excursion into the G major dominant and a totally new second tune gives the impression of modulation in the second verse. This pattern is repeated for verses 3 and 4, and seems set to govern verses 5 and 6 also, until the dream of victory and reunion prompts an unexpected and touching modulation to C major for the last strophe; when we hear this, we are somehow made to feel that it may indeed be Norman's swansong. Schubert has exactly understood the young knight's character — he is the salt of the earth, simple without being stupid, romantic without being sentimental. He invokes Maria's name at the end of the verses like a sacred litany; as he does so the vocal line blooms into high-lying melisma (the only such moments in a taxing piece where, as Vogl discovered to his cost, there is a tongue-twisting word for every syllable) and the final 'Maria' is even embellished with a turn as if in knightly homage. It seems fickle of Scott not to have let his readers know whether Mary ever sees her groom again or remains a virgin bride; it is perhaps enough that we are told that the Battle of Beal' an Duine was an extremely bloody one.

The texts of Ellen's three songs come from Scott's narrative poem 'The Lady of the Lake'. A literal rendering of Storck's translation is followed by Scott's original verses, in italics.

Raste Krieger! Krieg ist aus,
Schlaf den Schlaf, nichts wird dich wecken,
Träume nicht von wildem Strauß
Nicht von Tag und Nacht voll Schrecken.

In der Insel Zauberrhallen
Wird ein weicher Schlafgesang
Um das müde Haupt dir wallen
Zu der Zaubrerharfe Klang.
Feen mit unsichtbaren Händen
Werden auf dein Lager hin
Holde Schlummerblumen senden,
Die im Zauberlande blühen.

Raste Krieger, Krieg ist aus,
Schlaf den Schlaf, nichts wird dich wecken.
Träume nicht von wildem Strauß,
Nicht von Tag und Nacht voll Schrecken.

Nicht der Trommel wildes Rasen,
Nicht des Kriegs Gebietend Wort,
Nicht der Todeshörner Blasen
Scheuchen deinen Schlummer fort.

Nicht das Stampfen wilder Pferde,
Nicht der Schreckensruf der Wacht,
Nicht das Bild von Tagsbeschwerde
Stören deine stille Nacht.

Doch der Lerche Morgensänge
Wecken sanft dein schlummernd Ohr,
Und des Sumpffieders Klänge
Steigend aus Geschliff und Rohr.

Raste Krieger! Krieg ist aus,
Schlaf den Schlaf, nichts wird dich wecken
Träume nicht von wildem Strauß,
Nicht von Tag und Nacht voll Schrecken.

Rest, warrior! Your war is over,
Sleep the sleep, nothing shall wake you;
Do not dream of the fierce battle
Of days and nights filled with terrors.

In the island's enchanted halls
A soft lullaby
Shall caress your weary head
To the strains of a magic harp.

Fairies with unseen hands
Shall strew upon your bed
Sweet flowers of sleep
That bloom in the enchanted land.

Rest, warrior! Your war is over.
Sleep the sleep, nothing shall wake you;
Do not dream of the fierce battle
Of days and nights filled with terrors.

Neither the wild crash of drums,
Nor the summons to battle,
Nor the blaring of death's horns
Shall frighten away your sleep.

Neither the stomping of frenzied horses,
Nor the sentry's fearful cry,
Nor a vision of the day's cares
Shall disturb your tranquil night.

Yet the lark's morning song
Shall gently awaken your slumbering ear,
And the sounds of marsh birds
Soaring from reeds and rushes.

Rest, warrior! Your war is over,
Sleep the sleep, nothing shall wake you.
Do not dream of the fierce battle,
Of days and nights filled with terrors.

*Soldier rest! thy warfare o'er,
Sleep the sleep that knows not breaking;
Dream of battled fields no more,
Days of danger, nights of waking.
In our isle's enchanted hall,
Hands unseen thy couch are strewing,
Fairy strains of music fall,
Every sense in slumber dewing,*

Soldier rest! thy warfare o'er,
 Dream of fighting fields no more:
 Sleep the sleep that knows not breaking,
 Morn of toil, nor night of waking.
 No rude sound shall reach thine ear,
 Armour's clang, or war-steed champing,
 Trump nor pibroch summon here
 Mustering clan, or squadron tramping.
 Yet the lark's shrill fife may come
 At the day-break from the fallow,
 And the bittern sound his drum.
 Booming from the sedgy shallow.
 Ruder sounds shall none be near
 Guards nor warders challenge here,
 Here's no war-steeds neigh and champing,
 Shouting clans, or squadrons stamping.

King James V (1512-1542), heir to a war-torn kingdom, in an attempt to suppress the over-powerful Border chiefs, has banished the entire Douglas clan. This includes the aged Earl of Bothwell who has been the king's mentor. Despite the royal ukase, the old man is drawn back to his beloved native land; he and his wife and daughter (the beautiful Ellen Douglas) are given secret refuge in the domain of Roderick Dhu, chief of the Clan-Alpine, who defies the king in open rebellion.

Scott tells us that it was the custom of both James IV and James V to walk through their kingdoms in disguise, the better to understand their subjects. At the opening of *The Lady of the Lake*, the king, disguised as James Fitz-James 'the Knight of Snowdon' is hunting in the vicinity of Loch Katrine, the beauties of which he discovers by accident when he has lost his steed and is separated from his hunting companions. Climbing up a precipice, he catches sight for the first time of the bay with its islands which seem to him in the failing light like an enchanted part of another world. Scott's descriptions of this area brought hundreds of visitors to the Trossachs within weeks of the poem's publication. As 'Fitz-James' prepares to sleep in the open, a small skiff crosses the lake, rowed by a beautiful dark-haired young woman, dressed in the plaid of a chieftain's daughter.

Ellen had heard the sounds of a hunting horn and believes it might be her lover Malcolm Graeme on the lake shore. Instead Fitz-James introduces himself. In the solemn tradition of guest-friendship of those parts, Ellen invites Fitz-James home, and they row the boat back to a small rocky island in the middle of the loch. There, hidden away, is a 'rustic bower', a makeshift house made of wood and matting, half castle, half hermitage. Fitz-James recognizes an old sword as belonging to the banished Earl. Ellen's mother Dame Margaret is courtesy itself, but all enquiry about the head of the house is lightly turned away — indeed Ellen jokes that she and her mother cast spells on wandering knights, and as if to prove her point:

'She sung, and still a harp unseen
 Filled up the symphony between'.

This is the background to Schubert's masterful rondo 'Raste Krieger! Krieg ist aus', a story with which the composer was completely familiar — which is more than can be said for countless performers who have treated this song as a dirge or battle requiem. There is nothing of death in this poem; Ellen sings

to Fitz-James in order to draw attention away from the awkward subject of her father's whereabouts, and in welcoming her mysterious visitor she attempts to enchant him, more or less tongue-in-cheek, with beguiling music worthy of a Scottish Lorelei.

Schubert knew that in these mysterious circumstances, and in this strange hideaway, Ellen's music would have to make time stand still. He succeeds in doing this by its elongated time-span; in song terms, it has the long-term harmonic vision of the Great C major Symphony which we now believe to have been composed in the same year, and something of the 'heavenly length' ascribed to that symphony by Schumann. Schubert is not to be hurried, and he is not afraid of building arches of sound on harmonic foundations which move slowly, almost cosmically, from one chord to another. The opening ritomello in D flat is taken from a passage in the Klopstock ballad *Hermann und Thusnelda*, D322 (1815), where a handsome and victorious warrior is welcomed home by his beloved; a decade later, Schubert allows old music to float in a new delirium of spell-induced fancy. Verse 2 is an episode in C sharp major/minor and is (I believe) in the same tempo, a crotchet in the *alla breve* 'Langsam' equalling a crotchet of the 3/4 'Massig'. In this way the work glides along through the second appearance of the rondo (Verse 4) for ninety bars. At just the right moment the hypnotic calm is broken by the martial sounds of battle; the poet lists what will *not* disturb the warrior, but the composer, as if to lay potential dangers at rest like a Celtic shaman, invokes the horrors in musical illustration, the better to negate them. In any case, for variety's sake, the song needs the changes of pace in Verses 5 and 6. The fourth line of each of these verses switches from 'Fast' to 'Slower', although the piano's left hand timpani still rumble ominously. In a masterstroke of tempo engineering, Verse 7 is slower still, and it is here, when the harmony changes from B flat major to minor before 'Doch der Lerche Morgensänge,' that Schubert seems to be especially in touch with the spirit of Celtic simplicity and folksong-tinged enchantment. By the simple expedient of raising the piano's bass line by an octave, Schubert makes his horns of fairyland sound magically etiolated for the third and final appearance of the refrain.

Sir Walter Scott (1771-1832), translated by Adam Storck

ELLENS GESANG II

D838 Spring 1825; published in 1826 as Op 52 No 2

ELLEN'S SONG II

Jäger, ruhe von der Jagd!
Weicher Schlummer soll dich decken,
Träume nicht, wenn Sonn' erwacht,
Daß Jagdhörner dich erwecken.

Schlaf! der Hirsch ruht in der Höhle,
Bei dir sind die Hunde wach,
Schlaf, nicht quäl' es deine Seele,
Daß dein edles Roß erlag.

Jäger, ruhe von der Jagd!
Weicher Schlummer soll dich decken;
Wenn der junge Tag erwacht,
Wird kein Jägerhorn dich wecken.

Huntsman, rest from the chase!
Gentle slumber shall cover you;
Do not dream that when the sun rises
Hunting horns shall wake you:
Sleep! The stag rests in his den,
Your hounds lie awake beside you;
Sleep! Let it not torment your soul
That your noble steed has perished.

Huntsman, rest from the chase!
Gentle slumber shall cover you;
When the new day dawns
No hunting horn shall wake you.

*'Huntsman, rest! thy chase is done,
While our slumbrous spells assail ye,
Dream not, with the rising sun,
Bugles here shall sound reveillé'.
Sleep! the deer is in his den;
Sleep! Thy hounds are by thee lying;
Sleep! nor dream in yonder glen,
How thy gullant steed lay dying.
Huntsman, rest! thy chase is done,
Think not of the rising sun,
For at dawning to assail ye
Here no bugles sound reveillé.'*

In Scott's poem, Ellen's second song is a continuation of the first; the heading is *Song continued*, and the two pieces are separated by only a few lines of narration to give Ellen pause for breath. Directly after it is sung, Fitz-James's bed is prepared and decked with mountain heather. His dreams are disturbed by the beauty of Ellen, and memories of the loyalty of her father. Schubert's marking of 'Etwas geschwind' has encouraged many a performer, perhaps a bit embarrassed at the length of the first song, to treat *Jäger, ruhe von der Jagd!* in an altogether different manner for the sake of contrast: jaunty, perky, ebullient even. It so happens that interpretative help is at hand in the documents through a letter Anton Ottenwalt wrote to Josef von Spaun from Linz in July 1825 (already quoted in connection with *Normans Gesang*). Ottenwalt's articulate and perspicacious impressions of the Scott songs are of enormous value because they were formed by hearing the accompaniments played by the composer himself.

"Jägers Ruhe. Another slumber song, . . . in the accompaniment, the tune of horns, I should say, like the echoes of a hunting song in a beautiful dream . . . The most generally appealing by the loveliness of its melody and the rocking horn music . . . My dear fellow, how we wished each time that you could hear it! If only we could send those tunes into your dreams, as we ourselves hear them around us deep into the night."

The emotions aroused in Ottenwalt by a song he links with gentle dreams (as indeed the words suggest) are far from the Highland Fling mood of many a modern performance. It is a dance of delight perhaps, but one that is conjured by Ellen's 'slumbrous spells'. The key is E flat, with the soft horn calls ever evoked by that tonality (cf Beethoven Sonata Op 81a, *Les Adieux*). Sleep is a land through the looking glass and conscious and unconscious diverge in opposite directions. The first horn call rises upwards, and is answered by one which falls. In a similar way Bar 4 answers Bar 3. As the right hand descends the lines of the stave, the left ascends; as the vocal line climbs in the refrain, the piano moves in mirroring contrary motion. The song has a simple ABA form with a middle verse which magically modulates into C minor by a rise of a semitone (just before 'Schlaf! der Hirsch ruht in der Höhle') which is like a door opening into a new chamber of the unconscious. As in Ellen's first song, the composer illustrates what is not supposed to disturb the dreamer (urgent horn calls with a suggestion of stamping steeds), the better to allow him to exit from momentary nightmare when soothing dreams return; in the third line of Verse 2, nightmares are heard to recede during the word 'Schlaf' set to a dotted minim (after the second 'erlag'), and peace is restored fully as 'Seele' sinks to the security of the home key. The song's gentle dance rhythm and the repetition of the question and answer phrases somehow suggest a Scottish folk music dreamed up by the travelling-power of Schubert's imagination.

ELLENS GESANG III

D839 April 1825; published in 1826 as Op 52 No 6

Ave Maria! Jungfrau mild,
 Erhöre einer Jungfrau Flehen,
 Aus diesem Felsen starr und wild
 Soll mein Gebet zu dir hinwehen.
 Wir schlafen sicher bis zum Morgen,
 Ob Menschen noch so grausam sind.
 O Jungfrau, sieh der Jungfrau Sorgen,
 O Mutter, hör ein bittend Kind!
 Ave Maria!

Ave Maria! Unbefleckt!
 Wenn wir auf diesen Fels hinsinken
 Zum Schlaf, und uns dein Schutz bedeckt
 Wird weich der harte Fels uns dünken.
 Du lächelst, Rosendüfte wehen
 In dieser dumpfen Felsenkluft,
 O Mutter, höre Kindes Flehen,
 O Jungfrau, eine Jungfrau ruft!
 Ave Maria!

Ave Maria! Reine Magd!
 Der Erde und der Luft Dämonen,
 Von deines Auges Huld verjagt,
 Sie können hier nicht bei uns wohnen.
 Wir woll'n uns still dem Schicksal beugen,
 Da uns dein heil'ger Trost anweht;
 Der Jungfrau wolle hold dich neigen,
 Dem Kind, das für den Vater fleht.
 Ave Maria!

*Ave Maria! maiden mild!
 Listen to a maiden's prayer!
 Thou canst hear though from the wild,
 Thou canst save amid despair.
 Safe may we sleep beneath thy care,
 Though banish'd, outcast, and reviled --
 Maiden! hear a maiden's prayer;
 Mother, hear a suppliant child!
 Ave Maria!*

Ave Maria! Maiden mild!
 Listen to a maiden's entreaty
 From this wild unyielding rock
 My prayer shall be wafted to you.
 We shall sleep safely until morning,
 However cruel men may be.
 O Maiden, behold a maiden's cares,
 O Mother, hear a suppliant child!
 Ave Maria!

Ave Maria! Undefined!
 When we sink down upon this rock
 To sleep, and your protection hovers over us,
 The hard rock shall seem soft to us.
 You smile, and the fragrance of roses
 Wafts through this musty cavern.
 O Mother, hear a suppliant child,
 O Maiden, a maiden cries to you!
 Ave Maria!

Ave Maria! Purest Maiden!
 Demons of the earth and air,
 Banished by the grace of your gaze,
 Cannot dwell with us here.
 Let us silently bow to our fate,
 Since your holy comfort touches us;
 Incline in grace to a maiden,
 To a child that prays for its father.
 Ave Maria!

*Ave Maria! undefiled!
 The flinty couch we now must share
 Shall seem this down of eider piled,
 If thy protection hover there.
 The murky cavern's heavy air
 Shall breathe of balm if thou hast smiled;
 Then, maiden! hear a maiden's prayer;
 Mother, list a suppliant child!
 Ave Maria!*

*Ave Maria! stainless styled!
 Foul demons of the earth and air,
 From this their wonted haunt expired,
 Shall flee before thy presence fair.
 We bow us to our lot of care,
 Beneath thy guidance reconciled;
 Hear for a maid a maiden's prayer,
 And for a father hear a child!
 Ave Maria!*

The song was an immediate favourite in the Schubert circle, and the composer, in Upper Austria with the singer Vogl, half on holiday, half on a concert tour, seemed proud of it. In a letter to his father of 25 July 1825, he writes, "They wondered greatly at my piety which I expressed in a hymn to the Holy Virgin and which, it appears, grips every soul and turns it to devotion. I think this is due to the fact that I have never forced devotion in myself and never compose hymns or prayers of that kind unless it overcomes me unawares; but then it is usually the right and true devotion". Six weeks later Schubert mentions the song again, this time to his brother Ferdinand. In an age less touchy about sexing songs, he and Vogl have been performing it everywhere. "The manner in which Vogl sings and I accompany, as though we were one at such a moment, is something new and unheard-of for these people."

Such is the world-wide popularity of this song, and so often has it been performed with Latin text, that most people never connect it with Ellen Douglas and the plight of her father. In Scott's story this prayer follows hard on the heels of Norman's summons to arms. When the conflict between the king (whom she still does not realise is none other than Fitz-James) and Roderick Dhu comes to a head, Ellen joins her father in hiding in his rocky eyrie, fit more for wolf and wildcat than human habitation. Roderick Dhu, whose love of Ellen is unrequited, lingers in the vicinity and overhears her 'melting voice' which, harp-accompanied, seems to be that of an angel.

There is no doubt that Schubert, not conventionally religious, has been inspired by Scott to write a piece which reflects Ellen's character and purity, as much as that of the Virgin to whom she prays; her supplication to the Heavenly Mother is mirrored by her selfless devotion to her father on earth. Perhaps a devotion celebrating human goodness and love, as much as divine, is what Schubert meant by 'a right and true devotion'. The song, hypnotically strophic, has the same ineffable span as the opening pages of Ellen's first song. The music is relaxed and it glows the more for its unforced quality; the composer is happy and at peace with himself in this contented and productive summer. The vocal line reflects maidenly sorrow and religious devotion, but in the flowering of the melismas we hear also the ecstasy of a young woman with her whole future before her, a woman in love. This music does not deny that religious ecstasy and erotic impulse can be closely related. Despite her fears Ellen believes, or perhaps it is that Schubert believes, that life is, after all, beautiful. Modulations and effects never seem engineered, as they might have been (no matter how cleverly) in songs from earlier years; they seem to happen of their own accord. This song can be easily ruined by gratuitous rubato in the pianist's pervasive sextuplet figurations. Capell suggests that this accompaniment was inspired by Bach's 'Bell' cantata and, whether this is true or not, the music needs the selfless flow of the pre-romantic age. This style has sometimes been referred to as Bach's unstoppable 'sewing machine', but this song is powered rather by Gretchen's spinning-wheel raised to a higher power, no longer mirroring frantic unhappiness but slowly turning in a rhythm of undisturbed tranquillity, its movements governed by a cosmic energy more universal than the romantic fancy of any particular performer. One is in the grip of something extraordinary when performing this song, and audiences sensed that when they heard Vogl with Schubert at the piano. Each verse is really one long paragraph, flowing ineluctably to the final cadence of repeated litany. It is as if nothing can, or should, interrupt the flow of communion between Mary and her suppliant.



SIR WALTER SCOTT

Schubert composed eight solo settings of the poetry of SIR WALTER SCOTT, six of them on this disc. The songs from *The Lady of the Lake* were published as Op 52 in April 1826 in the order they are found in the epic (perhaps because audiences of the time were familiar with the story) beginning with *Ellens erster Gesang* and ending with *Lied des gefangenen Jägers*, sung by Ellen's imprisoned lover Malcolm Graeme. Also included were two choruses — *Bootgesang* for male chorus and *Coronach* for female. Schubert was especially keen that the songs should appear in a bilingual edition to increase his fame in England. Unfortunately, because he was unused to the language, the printed underlay is unsatisfactory, and only with cheating adaptation is it possible to perform the songs in English. *Normans Gesang*, where the translator has changed Scott's original metre, defies such adaptation.

It is difficult today to imagine the extent of Scott's fame, celebrated first for his epic poems (*The Lay of the Last Minstrel*, *Marmion*, *The Lady of the Lake*) and then (after a long period of anonymity) as the author of the many *Waverley* novels. Deutsch has it that the songs from *Montrose* and *The Pirate* on this disc were written in 1825; they would thus predate Scott's admitting to be the author of his novels in 1827. The Wittczek-Spaun collection dates the songs from 1827, and the authenticity of those dates may be argued by imagining the composer writing two songs to texts from old novels which had been newly authenticated as being by Scott, and thus likely to be more commercially viable. When arguing for the later date it also seems significant that neither *Norna* nor *Annot Lyle* make an appearance in the impromptu Scott concerts of 1825. The songs' publication in Vienna as Op 85,

containing Scott's name on the title page, dates from March 1828. In a modern age of copyright law, Scott would have made a fortune from the innumerable musical (not to mention literary) works spawned by his hard work. As it was, his health was undermined by the amount of writing it was necessary for him to do in order to maintain Abbotsford, his baronial castle, and to pay off the creditors when the publishing house Constable, of which he was a principal, declared bankruptcy.

Novalis (Friedrich von Hardenberg, 1772-1801)

15

MARIE

D658 May 1819 (?) first published in 1895

Ich sehe dich in tausend Bildern,
Maria, lieblich ausgedrückt,
Doch keins von allen kann dich schildern,
Wie meine Seele dich erblickt.

Ich weiss nur, dass der Welt Getümmel
Seitdem mir wie ein Traum verweht
Und ein unnennbar süßer Himmel
Mir ewig im Gemüte steht.

I see you in a thousand pictures,
Mary, sweetly portrayed;
Yet none of them can depict you
As my soul has seen you.

I only know that since then
The world's tumult has drifted away from me like a dream,
And an ineffably sweet heaven
Is forever in my heart.

Much more will be heard of the poet Novalis in a later edition of this series. The Schubert songs to his texts are an underestimated part of the canon but, for many reasons, a vitally important one. His *Marie* is included here as singer's motto and epilogue as we come full circle to end the disc in the mood with which it began. But not quite. Schubert's perfect page of music, exquisite in vocal and accompanimental detail, seems to me to set a poem which reconciles the two warring themes of this disc, idealism and reality, sacred and profane. In November 1794, Novalis met the twelve-year-old Sophie von Kuhn who was to remain his Beatrice and Laura, the focal point of the poet's life even after her death at the age of fifteen. After this unexpected catastrophe, Novalis wrote in his notebook: "I have religion for Sophie – not love. Absolute love, independent of the heart, grounded in faith is religion."

It seems clear that Marie, the Madonna, is interchangeable in Novalis's mind with Sophie. Is this what Rosemary Redford Reuther means when she describes the Marian cult as the 'spiritual eroticism' of males who, like Schubert, had to struggle in order to reconcile sexuality with religion? The many pictures Novalis has seen of Mary can never equal the inner picture he has of her. After Sophie's death, the idealised lover and the humanised mother of God became one, just as in the poet's mind the profane life of the artist is at one with the sacred love of the priest. Perhaps Schubert, who despised the hypocritical hellfire-threatening clerics he came across, would have agreed with what Novalis wrote about the coming together of two worlds:

"Poet and priest were one in the beginning — only later times have separated them. The true poet is however always a priest, just as the true priest has always remained a poet. Ought not the future to bring back this ancient condition of things?"

All notes and commentaries on this record are by GRAHAM JOHNSON ©.

All song translations are by RICHARD WIGMORE, taken from his *Schubert: The Complete Song Texts* (Victor Gollancz Ltd, London, 1988).

MARY

The Hyperion Schubert Edition

This record is Volume 13 in a series containing all of Schubert's songs, to be issued over the next few years with the aim of completing it in 1997, the bicentenary of the composer's birth. All of the records are planned by Graham Johnson, the accompanist throughout the series.

The following records are already issued.

Volume 1 DAME JANET BAKER mezzo soprano Compact Disc CDJ33001
Der Jüngling am Bache, D30; Thekla, D73; Schäfers Klage lied, D121; Nähe des Geliebten, D162; Meeres Stille, D216; Amalia, D195; Die Erwartung, D159; Wanderers Nachtlied I, D224; Der Fischer, D225; Erster Verlust, D226; Wonne der Wehmut, D260; An der Mond, D296; Das Geheimnis, D250; Lied, D284; Der Flüchtling, D402; An den Frühling, D587; Der Alpenjäger, D588; Der Pilgrim, D794; Sehnsucht, D636

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GRAHAM JOHNSON
in Schubert's local church in the Parish of Lichtental in Vienna's Ninth District